

Pictures at Ten



SEAN GEIST

Pictures at Ten
(A Wife-Watching Story)
By
Sean Geist

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All characters in this story are over the age of 18 unless specified. V1.2

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Chapter 1

Gunshots rang out. The hero reached under his jacket and pulled his hand out. His eyes grew huge; his palm was covered in blood.

“Oh shit,” he said and the screen faded to black.

“Fuckin' a.” My wife squeezed my elbow, startling me out of my shock. “They can't end that way.”

“That's why they call it a cliffhanger.” We had been watching this particular cop show for the past four years. It was a touchstone of our relationship which started when we met in European History at S.M.U our freshman year. I was studying Journalism, Daphne, my future wife, was majoring in Business Administration. A mutual admiration for Lawless Streets was the first thing we bonded over.

Daphne had her head in my lap. “They can't kill off Scott.”

“Don't worry. They won't.” He was the star; he drew eyeballs to a show that was getting long in the tooth. Without him, no one would watch.

We sat there and the credits rolled. My wife mumbled a few curse words at the show's writers.

As we watched, the image on the screen split in two; the left side showing the now unreadable end credits, the right filled with a head and shoulders shot of a rather handsome but, to us, unrecognizable man.

“Coming up on Metro-Plex News at Ten,” the man said, “Dallas mayor, Jan Pritchard, explains her decision not to run for a second term.” The image on the screen turned to shots of police surrounding a house somewhere in the city as the anchor teased the story of an armed standoff in Mesquite.

My wife sat up with a burst of energy I hadn't seen since the time she almost stepped on a snake while on a hike out in west Texas. "Who the heck is that?" Her voice filled with a mix of inquiry and admiration.

"Not sure." I knew all the local newsreaders; media was my passion as well as my chosen career.

As if, in answer to her question, the man's image re-appeared. "Those stories, and a look inside Cowboy's training camp. I'm Steve Speare and the News at Ten starts in one minute."

A car commercial came on and I looked around for the TV remote.

"You know, Daph, I heard rumors around the J-school, Metro-Plex was looking to replace Don. Guess they finally pulled the trigger."

MPN had been in fifth place in local news for the past decade. A media group based on the East Coast purchased the station earlier in the year in a bid to get a foothold in the country's fifth largest television market. After spending millions to build a new set, hire new reporters and upgrade equipment, it looked like they finally decided to replace their aging anchorman. We had discussed the topic in my advanced journalism class that spring. We thought they'd hire a woman or maybe an Hispanic or Black man. Looked like they decided on the safe, if unimaginative, route of a handsome young fair skinned man.

Well, in the end it didn't matter to us, we didn't watch Metro-Plex News. I was about to change the channel when my wife grabbed the remote from my hand.

"You're not switching channels." Daphne's eyes were glued to the set.

"Don't you want to watch Fox?" Channel Four had been our preferred station for local news.

"Not tonight. Let's try something different." At least until now.

We watched Metro-Plex News with their new anchor. I wasn't sure if a new face was going to matter in the big picture, but tonight, at least, their switch bought them at least two new viewers.

As a critical watcher, I had to admit, Steve Speare was a great choice. He looked about three decades younger than their previous anchor; that would attract a younger viewership. He was ruggedly handsome, with a solid jawline, light blond hair, cut short, and piercing blue eyes; that would please the female audience, as well as some of the gay male viewers. But he wasn't quite so hyper-masculine that he would drive off the straight guys.

I knew one viewer they hooked for sure: Daphne, the beautiful red-head who sat next to me on the couch. Every time Steve's face was on the screen her eyes were glued to it, no checking email or playing Candy Crush.

I got up to use the restroom while Steve was bantering with the weather guy and Daphne nearly pushed me over when I stepped between her and the TV set. By the time I got back, weather was done and it was time for sports. This is usually the time we head to bed. Not tonight.

I chuckled to myself as I watched my wife stare at Steve and Bill, the sport's guy, chatting about the Cowboys' prospects for the season. I knew she was just watching her new crush and not listening to what they were saying. Neither me, nor my wife, were football fans. At that moment my amusement over Daphne's infatuation turned a bit sour, as a hint of jealousy started seeping in. I needed to win back my wife's favor, no matter how silly that seemed. I decided to take my wife to bed and drive away any thoughts of that man from her head.

The image on the screen changed to training camp and I reached for my wife's hand, hoping to guide her to the bedroom and some passionate love-making.

“Hold up, Richard.” My wife turned to look at me, since Steve wasn't on the screen anymore. “I want to see the last story.”

I doubted she cared about the last story; she just wanted to see Steve's face again.

Other men might have been upset if their wife refused to go to bed with them and instead wanted to get one last glimpse of another man. I wasn't. Despite the fact we were a young couple, just a month out of college and still in our first year of marriage, I trusted my wife.

Humorously enough, I found myself a tad jealous, but also a little bit aroused.

Daphne spent the sport's segment fidgeting, like a junkie waiting for her next fix. She breathed an audible sigh when Steve re-appeared on screen. It was maddening watching her. I could only imagine it as similar to what women must think when they have to pull their men away from the TV during a football game.

“Thanks, Bill.” Steve's baritone voice again issued from our TV speakers. “Finally tonight, the Garland Recreation Department opened a new water park catering to the canine crowd.” Images of splashing dogs and equally wet pet owners filled the screen.

“Who ever wrote this drivel should be fired.”

Daphne must have taken my comment as a slander at Steve. “Think you could do better?” Her voice had a hint of indignation.

Yeah, as a matter of fact, I could, I thought to myself. “Why are you getting mad at me?”

“Cut Steve some slack. He's new.”

“And he probably didn't write that either.” I didn't want to get into a real argument over something so silly, so I decided to lighten up our quickly degrading conversation. “Sounds like someone has a crush.”

My wife's pale pink face turned rosy and a smile slowly formed on her lips.

“Maybe.” She looked so cute, like a teenage girl admitting she stole a kiss from the quarterback.

I left my wife to finish watching her new favorite broadcaster and went to get ready for bed. I didn't think much of her sudden interest in Steve Speare. Daphne and I were very open about what we liked and often teased each other when a hot man or beautiful woman caught our eye. We even had a freebie list; three celebrities we were allowed to sleep with, if the opportunity arose. I had a couple of Hollywood actresses and a tennis player on my list, at least one of whom was probably a lesbian. Daphne had the president and two baseball players.

We would often use our fantasy fucks during sex. Sometimes I'd ask my wife to close her eyes and think about one of her picks as I fucked her. And more than once, Daphne role-played, acting like one of the women on my list, as she seduced me. It was nothing more than a game to us, no one got hurt and we had great sex.

I was brushing my teeth and leaned over to rinse my mouth out, when I felt a pair of hands reach around and begin stroking my bare chest. I stood up and looked at my wife in the mirror. She was naked, save for a pair of light blue undies. Our eyes met in reflection. Her hazel pupils burned with a lust I hadn't seen since our honeymoon. She moved to kiss my neck and I lost the view of her face in a tangle of her deep red hair. I closed my own eyes and enjoyed the feeling of her lips brushing against my skin and her teeth lightly nibbling at my earlobe. She pressed her body against mine, squishing her breast against my back, her hardened nipples felt like small pebbles between us. I could feel a heat radiating from her pussy as she pressed it against my ass.

My cock stiffened as she whispered into my ear. “I want you inside me.” She slowly slid her hands down my hairy chest and into my pajama bottoms. One hand stroking my rapidly growing erection while the other moved lower to tickle my balls. My body was filled with sensual bliss and I didn't want her to stop, but she would have to, if I was to fulfill her desire.

I turned around to face my wife. She was pure sex. Her lidded eyes and lustful aroma drew out the animal in me.

I grabbed her head and kissed her, fiercely invading her mouth with my tongue. A moan escaped her lips and vibrated through me. Her fingers played violently through my hair, grasping and pulling, the pain enriched the pleasure that consumed me.

I moved my right hand to grope her breast, eliciting another sigh. My left moved further down, finding her lower lips engorged and moist with desire.

Something had triggered a surge in my wife's libido. We both enjoyed sex, but not like this, not with this much urgency. This was starvation sex, months without, our bodies demanding satiation.

My wife was rarely an instigator. Tonight, she was turned on like never before. She was not simply accepting my sexual advances, she was demanding them. And in the back of my mind, I knew the cause – Steve Speare, the blond hunk of an anchor. My wife had been driven to lust by his chiseled features and his soothing verbal delivery.

I would have mind-blowing sex tonight because Metro-Plex News hired a new newsreader, and I was going to ride this fantasy wave all the way to shore.

I moved our bodies around in an erotic dance, out of our en-suite and toward the bed. Without a word I turned my wife around and bent her over the mattress. Her protests as we parted turned to giggles of lust as I pulled

her panties off, leaving her bottom bare. I pushed my pajama bottoms down and lined up my steely hard cock against her swollen labia, rubbing the tip through her moist lips and against her throbbing clit.

“Stop teasing me.” Daphne moaned as I pushed forward, penetrating her. “God, that feels good.”

I leaned over my wife's body and began moving in a deep steady rhythm, each thrust drawing a sharp cry of pleasure. My lips brushed up against Daphne's ear. It was time to explore our passion. “You're not thinking of me, are you?”

My wife was silent, but I could sense her answer by the way her muscles pulsed around my cock. She knew, I knew. Words did not have to be exchanged.

“Just fuck me. Shut up and fuck me.”

I complied. I stood back up, grabbed her hips for support and began pounding my wife's pussy like I'd never done before. It was a unique experience for the both of us. For her part, Daphne met my thrusts with one of her own, each just as hard and fierce. My balls slapped her mound as our bodies clashed.

I could feel my climax building.

“Fuck me. Yeah. Fuck me.” My wife's words drove me on. I wasn't going to last much longer, but she still hadn't come.

“Give it to me. Give me your cum.” The dirty talk was driving me wild. I was about to explode. “Give it to me. Steve.”

I threw my head back and erupted. One long “fuck” issued from my mouth as I pumped my seed into Daphne's pussy. I couldn't see her face, but I knew she had to be smiling when she triggered my orgasm by invoking the name of her new crush.

Even after having such an explosive climax, I stayed hard and continued moving in and out. I was rewarded with the sensation of my wife's orgasm hitting. Her body started shaking and I felt her muscles constrict around me. I drove my cock as deep as I could and held it there. Moans and sighs spilled forth from Daphne's lips as I twitched my cock deep in her womb.

“Oh, God. Oh God. Oh”

Eventually, her climax ended and we reluctantly disengaged.

Later, after cleaning the sweat and cum from our bodies, we lay together cuddling.

“That was incredible.” The words seemed inadequate as they passed my lips.

“You're not mad at me?”

I knew why my wife asked that question, but I played dumb. “Why would I be mad?”

“The stuff about Steve.” Daphne's body tensed as she mentioned his name. Maybe she was afraid how I'd react, maybe she was having another moment of pleasure. Either way, I didn't care. I needed to comfort her, so I drew her close.

“It's just a fantasy, Daph. Nothing to get mad about. It's like me and Haley.”

“Haley Martin?”

“Yeah. She's hot. I think about her when I masturbate sometimes.”

My wife slapped my arm.

“Now, you're the one getting mad.” She started giggling.

“Hypocrite.” I started tickling her. She tickled back and we started wresting. Our grappling turned to groping and we were soon making love again. This time slow and subdued, but with no less pleasure.

After we both climaxed, I held my wife tight against me, my cock still inside her. "I will always love you, Daphne. You're the rhythm of my heart."

"Even when you're lusting after some red-head actress?"

"Even when you're wetting yourself over some handsome news anchor."

We both smiled and kissed. My erection had been softening, but talk of love and lust started blood flowing again.

"Really, Richard?"

"I know. We got work tomorrow."

"Save it for later." Daphne kissed me on the nose. "Night, love"
She rolled over toward her side of the bed, I rolled to mine.

"And she's blond now."

"What?" My wife's weary voice was almost inaudible.

"Never mind. Good night, Daffy."

"Night. Steve."

"Bitch," I chuckled.

Good news likes to spread and so two weeks later, I found myself slipping out of our apartment and making the half mile walk to the light rail station. On the train, I was surrounded by business men taking a late lunch, a few homeless people trying to avoid the scorching summer heat, kids enjoying one of the last few days of summer vacation; I ignored them all, rapt in my own joy.

A soft feminine voice announced my stop at the hospital where Daphne worked, making sure all the accounts payable added up.

“Must be something special to get you all the way out here.”

I was sipping a cup of coffee in the small cafe off the main admitting lounge. “It is. Sit.”

Daphne set down her spinach salad with grilled chicken. “I’ve only got half an hour.”

I started in, while she shoveled the leafy veggies into her mouth. “I did it; I got the job.”

My wife stopped and stared, her fork halfway between the bowl and her mouth. “At the station in Des Moines?” The look on her face was frozen. I knew she didn’t really want to move to Iowa, but none of the stations in Dallas would hire me fresh out of college. The NBC affiliate in Des Moines would.

“Yup. They want me to start in two weeks.”

We had already talked about the move before I applied. The station was offering about as much as Daphne was making at the hospital, which was infinitely more than the nothing I was making as an unemployed graduate.

My wife continued eating. She didn’t say anything, but the look in her eyes told the tale: anger, over having to leave her job and hometown, uncertainty about our future in an unfamiliar state, and finally accepting our life together required me starting my career at the bottom at some down market station in the middle of a cornfield. By the time she put her fork down, I had convinced myself she was excited about the move; she wasn’t.

“They paying to move us?”

“No. But I do get a thousand dollar advance.” We didn’t have much to move, just our clothes, some small appliances, a couple boxes of books neither of us wanted to part with and other personal odds and ends.

“This really what you want?”

I paused before answering. I really wanted to work in Dallas, but that wasn't going to happen without first getting experience elsewhere.

“You know I want to end up back here. But I gotta start somewhere else, somewhere smaller. So, yes, it's what I want.”

“What if I said no?” Daphne's tone indicated she was serious. We had already gone over this. She knew my answer.

“Well, I'm not going without you. So I guess I'd politely tell them to stuff their job offer.”

My wife held her face still. She was thinking, or so she would have me believe.

“I have been getting used to living without a job.”

She scowled.

“Sleeping in 'til ten. Having beer at lunch.”

Daphne's scowl started to crack as I watched.

“Eating ice cream out of the tub as I lay on the sofa, watching my shows.”

She finally broke and started laughing. “Or you could just get a fucking job here.” Her smile belayed her words. She knew I had been looking for a job here, all kidding aside, and that no one was hiring. “Okay hubby. You head home and start packing. I'll go give my notice.”

We both got up and headed back to the reception area. We stopped and kissed goodbye at the exit.

“See you around six?”

“I might be a little late. The girls will want to take me out for drinks after I spring the news.”

“I'll have dinner ready by seven.”

“Sounds good.”

Daphne turned to head back to her office but stopped after only a couple steps. “One more thing.” She came back to me. “You owe me big for this, buster. And I won't forget it.”

She kissed me on the cheek and strode away.

I smiled to myself, fully aware she wouldn't.

Chapter 2

So we packed up what little we owned into our pickup truck and drove seven hundred miles to our new home.

Getting settled in was rough. I was producing the noon newscast and that meant I had to get up at three in the morning to be at work by four. That meant most of the burden of getting our apartment set up fell on Daphne.

She took it well, considered it a vacation, she said. As she told it, unpacking our stuff, buying new furniture, and arranging the home was a breeze compared to the drudgery of making the numbers add up at the hospital, but I knew she missed work and couldn't wait to get back to it.

"Good show, today." Daphne was putting a few books on a shelf she had put up on our living room wall.

It was my one month anniversary at the station.

"Thanks, hon." I kissed my wife on the cheek. "But you have to say that. My boss would beg to differ. He had a whole page of nits to pick with me."

"Poor thing. Let me get you a beer."

Yes, I drink beer at one in the afternoon. It's the end of my day. I was re-arranging the books, putting them in alphabetical order by author, when she returned with a glass of Harp.

"That's the last one." Daphne pointed the bottle she was drinking out of, at the empty cardboard box at my feet.

"We should celebrate. How about I take you out to dinner?"

"It's a work night." Daphne was reminding me I usually went to bed at seven.

“You saying I need that much beauty rest?” I slapped my wife playfully on the ass as she placed the last book on the shelf; it was out of order, I'd have to move it later.

She turned to me with a stern look. “Hey, watch it.” She held her jaw tight, her brow furrowed for two beats, before she started giggling. My wife looked so beautiful when she laughed. Her face lit up with amusement, her lips parted in an active smile.

It was moments like this that reminded me just how lucky I was to have Daphne in my life.

I grabbed her around the waist and kissed her. “That's it. We are officially, no longer, living out of boxes. We have to go out. I'll take a nap, we'll get an early seating at Sam's, and I'll be in bed by eight.”

We kissed and hugged and Daphne said something about taking a nap with me. We usually ate lunch together at this time; it was the only meal we shared during the week. Today we skipped it and headed to the bedroom.

I intended to get some rest so I wouldn't be too tired at work the next day. My wife had different plans.

Because of our mis-matched schedule we hadn't had sex in over three weeks. Either I was too tired, or Daphne had too much organizing to do.

When we got to the bedroom, Daphne set me down on the bed, got on her knees in front of me and began taking my pants off.

“You don't have to do that.” I prayed she wouldn't listen to me.

“Oh, I know that Richard dear.” She started stroking and leaned in to lick a drop of pre-cum off the tip of my swelling member. “It's been too long since I've had a cock in me.” Daphne took me into her warm mouth and bobbed a few times. “So you're going to have to put out for me this afternoon.”

God had answered my prayers. I flopped back and closed my eyes as I enjoyed the wet sensation of my wife's mouth around my erection.

After a too short moment of bliss I could feel my climax approaching and was about to shout a warning.

“Oh no you don't buddy.” My wife could also tell I was close. “You need to satisfy me first.”

We switched positions after removing the rest of our clothes. I breathed deep the musky aroma of my wife's sex. My head felt at home between her thighs, licking along the neatly groomed edges of her labia, drawing my tongue across her pebbly skin, delving deep into her warm dewy lips before lapping her clit like it was candy.

Despite the recent lack of action, our sex life was good. We both enjoyed pleasing each other orally and digitally. Sometimes I would direct our actions, other times, like today, Daphne was in control. It was a true partnership and at the moment I was tonsil deep in my wife's pussy and loving it.

After she came, I moved up her body. My face was slick with her juices but she didn't shy away from my kiss. Instead, she devoured my lips, consuming her own essence.

“Put it in.” She nipped at my ear lobe as I drove my steely hard cock between deep inside her.

I started thrusting, hard and fast. I could feel her muscles pulsing and I knew she was close to another climax.

“Shit, Rich. That feels so fucking good.”

I said nothing.

“It's been so long. If you'd brushed me off, I was ready to go out and buy a vibrator.”

I must have been losing my touch. I picked up the pace of my fucking and my wife stopped speaking in coherent sentences and just started mumbling a series of ohs and ahs and fucks.

I could feel a knot of pressure building at the base of my cock, three weeks of pent up sperm waiting to be released; actually it was a week and a half, but I didn't feel bad about it, I'm sure Daphne rubbed out a few since our last coupling.

As I erupted, shooting several strong ropes of cum into my wife, I felt her pussy walls begin contracting, like she was sucking the semen from my body, consuming every single drop of me.

It was joy.

After we came, we both fell asleep from exhaustion. We ended up sleeping longer than we planned so, instead of going out, we ordered Chinese delivery. We opened a nice bottle of Cabernet to enjoy with it.

I did end up getting to sleep around seven-thirty, so that was good. Daphne stayed up to watch a DVD. I was dead to the world and didn't know when she finally came to bed. She was peacefully dozing next to me when my alarm went off at three.

It didn't take long for Daphne to find a new job. Less than a week after we finished unpacking she was hired by the Iowa Medical Center to assist in their accounting department, pretty much the same thing she did in Dallas, just for a little less money.

And from that point on, we became like trains, passing on the tracks, each going in a different direction. I was at work when she got up in the morning. She was at work when I arrived home. The only time we really

saw each other, during the week, was the hour or so after she got home and before I went to sleep.

It was a stable, if not totally satisfying, routine, but we made up for it on the weekends. I'd take a nap after work on Friday and get up when Daphne got home. We'd spend the weekend catching up with each other's life, workplace drama, mostly. I usually had the more interesting stories, like which anchor almost got a DUI and which reporter was sleeping with his photographer. The accounting department at the hospital was bone dry in comparison. Until Brad got hired.

Daphne had been working there almost six months when she told me about him. We were having coffee at Starbucks one Saturday morning, when his name first came up.

“Brad was in rare form today.”

“And who's Brad?”

“Our new receptionist. He's been here a week and already he's hit on just about all the women in Accounting.”

My ears perked up. “Really? All the women? Including you?”

Daphne looked up at me, mischief in her eye's. “You worried?”

“Should I be?” We both had lots of questions, no answers.

My wife told me, “of course not,” but she didn't tell me if Brad had hit on her, and I didn't ask again. From then on, Brad became a topic we both used to tease each other.

One day, my wife mentioned he'd started dating one of the nurses and I asked her if she was jealous. She looked at me with a raised eyebrow and kept right on talking.

When I was too tired and wasn't able to pick up her birth control pills at the pharmacy she threatened to ask Brad to do it for her.

Overall, we just loved giving each other grief, and Daphne's flirty co-worker was an ideal candidate for harmless jokes.

Things got more interesting on my first trip away from home for work.

Every four years, life in Iowa becomes a political carnival and the eyes of the nation turn to this flat desolate wasteland to be entertained. Iowans get first crack at voicing their preference of candidates, so this means that for the two months leading up to caucus night, there's never a day when at least two candidates can't be found somewhere in the Hawkeye state.

As a television news producer I began to live and breathe presidential election coverage. I was following all the polls, I knew all the campaign managers by their first names and I could probably spit out their talking points better than the candidates themselves.

Work demands left me little personal time to spend with my wife and by deep December I found myself semi-celibate; it had been almost two months since Daphne and I had fucked, fifty-six days to be exact. Yes, I wanted to spend quality time with my wife, but one of us always seemed to be too busy or too tired, even when we did have time together.

Six weeks before the caucus, I was sent to Cedar Rapids as a member of our news team covering a multi-night debate which every candidate from both major political parties would be attending.

After the first night's event, I was alone in my hotel room when she called.

"God, Rich. I really wish you were here," were the first words she spoke to me after I answered my cell phone.

It sounded urgent. "Is everything ok?"

"No!"

Now I was worried. I told her if it was an emergency, I'd head right home.

“Would you?”

“Are you hurt?”

“No. I just need you badly.”

“You need me?”

“I need you inside me. God, I'm horny.”

I didn't know if I was more pissed or relieved to hear she was physically okay, if a little randy.

“Since you were away, I decided to go out for drinks with the girls after work.”

“It's Thursday night. Don't you have to work tomorrow?”

“It was only a couple drinks at happy hour. You're such a lightweight.”

I was not a lightweight. At least, I didn't think I was. “Go on.”

“So, guess who joined us?” Before I could say his name, Daphne beat me to it. “Brad!”

“Was his girlfriend there?”

“No. She dumped his ass last week. That's why he was invited, so he could drown his sorrows with cheap whiskey and we could hear some juicy stories. It was win-win.”

I didn't ask who had done the inviting. It sounded like something Daphne would do. She had a thing for wounded puppies and she did love her gossip.

I was afraid to ask, but I did. “So why are you horny?”

“Promise you won't get mad.”

I promised, but I had my fingers crossed.

“So, anyway. Brad told us how he discovered Leslie was seeing her ex on the side. He got a peek at a few suggestive text messages on her phone and decided to confront her about it.”

“I thought you said, she dumped him?”

“Richard, let me finish. Anyway, he confronted her, she confessed and he forgave her. Two days later, she sent him a text saying she didn't want to see him anymore 'cause she didn't trust him after he snooped her phone.

“What the fuck, we said. She fucked around on you and then has the ovaries to say she has trust issues. We spent two or three hours, longer than we should have, buying Brad drinks, and lending our shoulders for him to cry on, and maybe a few of us flirted with him. A bit.”

This last line got my attention.

“I take it, you mean, you flirted with him.”

“Come on, Rich, he was sad and needed cheering up.”

I'm not getting mad, I said to myself as I started getting mad. I was also getting aroused.

“How did the flirting go?” I kept my voice as neutral as possible.

Silence on the other end.

“Daphne?”

A pause and then her voice came on, low and hesitant. “I put my arm around him.” Another short pause. “I kissed his cheek. Once.”

My hand balled into a fist as my dick turned rock hard. Why was I aroused at the thought of my wife making out with another man.

“I might have let him, feel me up.”

“Daphne!” I think my fingernails drew blood from my palms. I'm pretty sure my cock twitched.

More silence. I was afraid we'd lost the connection, or worse, she'd hung up. Then I made out a few snorts, like she might have been crying, but then she started giggling. “He might have motor-boated my tits.” My wife barely got the words out through her laughter.

“Are you shitting me?”

“Rich, you are so easy to tease.”

I decided at that moment to turn the tables.

“Wow, cause thinking about your Brad, with his face in your chest, has me rock hard.” It was true. “In fact, I’m stroking myself right now.”

I did, in fact, pull my cock out and started playing with it, rubbing a little pre-cum along the sensitive crown.

Now it was Daphne’s turn to wonder. “Really? You’re aroused at the thought of me fooling around?”

“Yeah.” And I wasn’t lying. I did get hard at the thought, although I was sure I wouldn’t want her to actually do it. Fantasy was one thing, real life brings real consequences.

“What if I told you I did put my arm around him and I did kiss his cheek, but it was Phyllis who actually let him feel her up.” It didn’t sound like a question.

“So you almost had a threesome?”

“Would you like to see that?”

I didn’t answer right away. I was jerking off and not in my right mind. I didn’t want to embarrass my wife, nor did I want to encourage her to cheat on me. I did want her to continue exploring the fantasy.

“Depends. What am I seeing?”

She was silent for a moment and I thought I heard the rustle of clothing.

“You still there?”

“Just getting more comfortable. Like I said, I’m horny. You still want me to go on?”

“Yeah.” My voice might have squeaked.

“You masturbating?”

“Maybe.”

“Well guess you won’t mind if I join you.”

“Not if you keep talking.”

Daphne went on to describe her hypothetical threesome with Brad and Phyllis. “We hustled him into the ladies room at the bar and locked the door. Phyllis, the little slut, got on her knees and took out his cock to suck it.

“Brad just ran his hands through her hair and leaned his head back. She's blond, you know. Sucks dick like a blond, too. It looked so dirty, and sexy. I lifted my skirt and started stroking my clit, like I'm doing now. I was so fucking wet from the kissing and playing earlier. I was leaning on the sink next to them and was surprised when Brad turned to me and grabbed the hand that was between my legs. He brought it to his mouth and started licking my fingers.

“He smiled and slipped his free hand up my skirt and resumed what he'd interrupted. God, Rich. It felt good. Feeling his thick, rough, fingers kneading my button. I don't know how long he keep working on me, but eventually he thrust his fingers inside me and I came. He covered my mouth with his to catch my screams. I could taste myself on his lips and was so good.”

My wife's words started to slow. I imagined her, alone, moving her own fingers through the folds of her sex, perhaps pausing to taste herself.

“I'm close, Richard.”

Throughout her monologue I continued to stroke myself, varying my speed so as not to come too soon, but I was also close and I told her with a moan.

“Come with me, Rich.” And then she started sighing, a breathy low sigh that rose in intensity as her orgasm grew.

“Oh, Rich. He's. He's. Brad's putting it inside me.” And she nearly screamed and that set me off. My cock erupted, sending several long blasts

of pearly fluid arching in the air to land on the carpet by the bed.

It was so intense. We just breathed together over the phone for a few minutes. As the emotional high of arousal faded, the vacuum it left was quickly filled with jealousy and guilt.

Before I came, it excited me to think about Daphne with another man, but post orgasm, I was worried she'd be mad at me, or encouraged to cheat on me in real life, or worse, to think I might want to sleep with another woman.

"Was it good for you?" All my worries were swept away by her words. "Cause it was great for me."

"I can't wait to get back home, so I can give you a proper fucking."

"You're heading back Saturday afternoon, right?" That would be in two days.

"Yeah."

"I might go out again with the gang tomorrow night. Drinks are two for one at Larry's Place by the university."

"Will Brad be there?"

"Probably." She drew out the word.

"Will you be a good girl?"

"Should I?"

"If you're not, you'll have to tell me about it."

"Oh, don't worry. I will."

We said our goodbyes, and I went to bed, my mind filled with thoughts of my beautiful wife being deliciously naughty. I awoke the next morning with a raging hard-on and an intermittent ringing in my ears.

“Hello,” I said after picking up the phone next to my bed. It was just after six in the morning.

“Why are you still in bed?” It was my boss, back at the station in Des Moines.

“Cause it's gonna be a late night. Debates at seven – I figure you guys want hits at nine and ten.” My voice was rough, my words jumbled as I tried to re-enter the waking world.

“Turn on CNN. I need to see Tiffany's bright shiny face on our air in an hour.” The line then went dead.

“Fuck me.”

I turned on the TV and was greeted with the breaking news logo. Tonight's debate was called off. One of the two remaining candidates had dropped out of the race overnight handing her opponent the nomination.

Our reporter was still brushing her teeth outside the venue and I was putting the finishing touches on her report, when my photographer started his countdown. Thirty seconds to air. I tossed Tiffany my notepad; she tossed her toothbrush to me.

She gave her report like she'd been up all night writing it – in reality it was mostly tidbits from the wire services, followed by a soundbite from the former candidate I'd cut from an earlier package.

The rest of the morning was spent collecting comments from the remaining candidate, her staff, her opponent's supporters and the opposing party. We had a two minute report ready for the top of the noon show and then we were free. Most of the networks had packed up and left town.

I was given a head start on my weekend.

I thought about calling Daphne and asking if she wanted to scrap her plans and have dinner with me. I probably should have; instead I decided to surprise her.

Our crew left Cedar Rapids around two and we were back in Des Moines by four. I went home to change and decided to meet up with my wife at her happy hour, have a few drinks and then take her home to make good on the fucking I promised.

I figured showing up around six-thirty would give my wife plenty of time to socialize before I showed up to monopolize her attention.

Larry's Place was one of the most popular nightclubs in the city and it was hopping, even for a Friday evening. Loud music and cigarette smoke filled the air. It was one of the last clubs near the University that still allowed smoking, and so, in deference to a couple of Daphne's co-workers this was where they liked to meet-up.

The place was laid out in three levels – concentric circles – each one a couple steps higher than the last. The first level was table service – a few sunken plush leather sofas seating up to nine people comfortably interspersed among the standard four tops. I did a quick walk around and didn't see my wife, so I made my way up one of the four access stairs to the dance floor level. It was tough moving through the sea of bodies, rhythmically moving to the beat of an unseen DJ.

I was never going to find Daphne through the dim smokey haze so I made my way up to the bar – the top most level. I ordered a drink, a cheap domestic beer, and perched myself at the railing overlooking the dance floor. I thought about pulling out my cell phone and calling her, but I figured with the music and loud conversations going on, she wouldn't hear her phone go off – Daphne never put her phone on vibrate.

So I stood and scanned the crowd between sips of my mediocre beer. Each time my eyes fell upon a flash of red hair I thought it must be her, but I was wrong – until I wasn't.

I had turned back to get another beer when I spotted her, leaning against the far end of the bar, trying to get the bartender's attention. With what she wore, it didn't take long.

Now granted, I hadn't been out on a fancy date with Daphne since we'd moved to Iowa, so it wasn't surprising I'd never seen her in the outfit she now wore. It was stunning and illustrated just how beautiful and sexy my wife was. She wore a pair of tight black jeans, ones I had seen, but not with her in them. She had on a pair of healed cowboy boots that accented her legs just right. All of this was lost on the bartender, whose attention was grabbed by the body hugging maroon sweater, which gave him an excellent view of her bountiful cleavage. I really hoped she didn't wear that outfit to work. I doubted Brad would get any work done if she did.

Like a professional, the bartender took one quick look down at her breasts – no man could resist – and back up to her eyes. My wife looked so sexy, I could feel my penis stiffen in my pants and I had to take a moment to adjust. For this, the darkness was my friend.

I started toward Daphne but immediately froze when I noticed she wasn't alone. As soon as the bartender turned away to get her drinks she began chatting with the guy to her right. This put her back, and curvy ass, to me, but it gave me a good view of him. His short blond hair seemed to sparkle in the purple florescent light. His white dress shirt was unbuttoned halfway down his chest and he wore, what appeared to be, tight fitting blue jeans.

Everyone in this club seemed to be wearing tight clothing except me. Then again, I wasn't really dressing to impress anyone. I was expecting to pickup my wife, someone already attracted to me. Looking at how Daphne was dressed, she might be trying to pick up someone herself.

The thought sent my heart spinning with jealousy and lust. My buxom red-head beauty, my Daphne, dressed like she was looking to score, thinking her husband was over a hundred miles away. I again had to adjust my cock as blood continued to flood there, leaving my brain to make do. My heart skipped a beat when I saw her place a hand on the other man's arm. It was a friendly gesture, but one my overactive imagination could easily mistake as flirting.

Daphne laughed at something he said and he leaned in for what I thought might be a kiss, but before that fear could be confirmed, the bartender returned with their drinks – three bottles of beer and a mixed drink. My wife's companion, Brad I was sure, took the drinks and headed off down toward one of the tables on the lower level; I lost him soon after he left my wife's side, since she was the focus of my attention. She turned to order a couple more drinks, and that's when I decided to approach, but, again, I wasn't fast enough.

Another man – this one in a business suit, his tie undone, his muscles barely contained in the expensive fabric, like wearing clothes that fit was out of style – moved up to the bar directly between me and my wife. He was at least a foot taller than her and she had to crane her neck to look him in the eye. He could easily get a good look at her tits without breaking eye contact. She smiled at what he said and even laughed once or twice. It never failed to impress me, just how easily Daphne got along with men, not only me and her co-workers, but complete strangers; I was guessing he was a complete stranger. I guess I shouldn't be too surprised, my wife was naturally comfortable around people – which was why I found it funny she went into accounting and not public relations.

My erection continued to harden as my stomach attempted to crawl out my throat. I felt queasy, but thrilled, like I was riding a roller-coaster, my

heart racing with fear and excitement. Daphne was more than just my wife, she was a beautiful woman, a sexual being. She was aware of her attraction and seemed to revel in it. I promised myself never to forget that.

She continued to talk to the guy, even after her two other drinks arrived. The man tried to pay for them but Daphne laughed him off. He seemed surprised, but not put off. After a few more minutes my wife picked up the drinks and seemed to say goodbye.

Mr. Businessman was obviously taken with her, and by the smile on her face and the thank you that tumbled from her lips, he was telling her as much. He took out a business card and pen and wrote something down – probably his personal phone number. He handed the card to my wife and a dark green monster arose in my chest and nearly suffocated me. The talking and flirting didn't seem to bother me as much, but this crossed a line. I was burning with hatred for this man trying to hook up with my wife.

Daphne looked at the card and smiled. For an instant, I was petrified. Would she take his number and call him later? Maybe set up a date for another time I was away, or call him later tonight since she still didn't know I was home. All my fears and insecurities wrapped themselves into a tight spiked ball and lodged in my throat, making it hard to breathe.

I looked at the man again. He was handsome – in a strong, rugged way – with a chiseled jaw, a strong roman nose and a healthy muscular physique. He looked like he could work on Wall Street or for some mob boss. I also imagined he was packing quite a monster in his pants. I'm well equipped in that department, even though, like every man, I'd like to be bigger, regardless of what my wife says, there will always be someone longer and thicker who could reach places I can't. I could see Daphne going off with the man, maybe have some fun with him, and coming back to me.

My fantasies of a cheating wife straddled the border of becoming real and I wasn't sure how I felt. I was aroused, no doubt. The thought of watching my wife – even just imagining her – being unfaithful caused my cock to pulse. My mind screamed no, but my erection screamed yes, and my stomach was caught in the middle.

To my delight, and dismay, Daphne waved her left hand at her suitor, drawing his attention to the ring on her finger. She placed the business card back in his breast pocket, said goodbye and turned to rejoin her friends.

For his part, Mr. Businessman took her rejection well. He didn't get visibly mad, call her a slut or cunt, or storm off. He simply smiled and took a sip of his drink. He was obviously a man used to rejection but fully confident he wasn't going home alone tonight. Despite the fact he wanted to fuck my wife, I wished him well. He was chatting with a couple of young blond women when I walked past him to follow Daphne. There were lots of giggles and smiles and laughs, and I just had to mentally applaud.

My wife rejoined her co-workers at one of the tables on the lower level. I watched them from the edge of the dance floor, doing my best to avoid drawing their attention. Daphne was one of the youngest of the group of six, four women and two guys, including the blond I figured was Brad. The group morphed throughout the evening, a woman would wander off toward the restroom, a couple would make their way to the dance floor, the guys went to get drink refills. Nothing awkward, or overtly naughty happened and I started to feel embarrassed. I don't know what I was expecting to find. Daphne never gave me any need to doubt she loved me and I never thought she'd cheat on me. Our fantasies were just that. We'd tease each other about Brad and Steve and Haley, but it was all in fun, and we both knew it.

I had meant to surprise my wife, but instead she surprised me. Ever since we meet, I hadn't really seen her as an individual, apart from me. But here she was, having fun, obviously doing some friendly flirting, but staying faithful.

I turned and headed for the exit. I'd save my surprise for later. I was still hard for my wife, but I could wait. She needed time to just be Daphne and not Mrs. Hawks. When I got to the door I looked back at the table. I thought I might have seen my wife get up with one of the guys and head toward the dance floor. Maybe they were going to dance, maybe just get more drinks. I could have stayed to watch, I wanted to stay and watch, but it would be wrong.

Daphne was going to do what she was going to do. She'd tell me about it later, of that I was sure. Hadn't she told me about going out, where she was going and who was going to be there. I don't think she'd leave out what she did, unless she actually fucked Brad or Mr. Businessman. That fleeting thought sent a surge of blood to my cock and a shiver up my spine, but instead of continuing to stalk my wife, I went home.

I'd like to say I settled down, read and took a nap, instead I paced around the apartment, worrying about what my wife was up to and regretted leaving the club when I did. I know coming home was the right thing to do but that didn't make it any easier. I had to control my understandable insecurities.

I wished I had the attitude of Mr. Businessman, always moving forward though life – no worries, no regrets – confident and secure. I think I took my first step in that direction, when I left the club without accosting Daphne and her friends. I had to let this play out, let her come home to me on her own.

It was a tough night to get through. I would have much rather been covering a political debate. There were several times, especially when it got around ten o'clock, when I almost headed back out to Larry's. I overcame those urges and when Daphne finally got home, at half past midnight, I was glad I did.

I was lying in bed, not asleep but not totally awake either, when I was startled by bright light flooding the room.

“Jesus Christ!” Daphne stood at the doorway to our bedroom, her red hair the only identifying feature I could make out as my eyes slowly adjusted to the light.

“Surprise.” The word tumbled hesitantly out of my mouth, sounding more like a question than an exclamation.

“Richard, you scared the living shit out of me. Didn't expect you home 'til tomorrow.”

“Guess you didn't hear the news about the debate.”

“You know I don't follow politics.”

My wife headed straight to the bathroom, peeling off her clothes as she went. The stench of alcohol and cigarettes wafted in her wake. I followed her to our en-suite.

She stood at the sink in her black lacy bra and panties; her sweater and jeans were piled on the chair next to our bed.

“Sorry I scared you. Didn't you see my car in the parking lot?”

“Didn't drive home.” Daphne splashed a bit of water on her face and began scrubbing off the day's mask. “Was too drunk.” She was a raccoon, a burglar – her hazel eyes surrounded by a black smear of mascara and eye liner. “Brad dropped me off.”

Hearing her say his name bit. I had to brush it off, laugh in the face of the little green imp trying to sneak up on me.

“Guess it's a good thing you didn't invite him in.”

My wife slowly turned her head to face me. A quizzical look spread across her eyes. “Why?”

Silence hung in the air between us, broken only by the soft sloshing of frothy water in the sink.

She was playing innocent. I couldn't have that. I needed to press on; the imp insisted.

“You know. Hubby away on business.”

Daphne's eyes grew wide. “Richard Hawks, you really think I'd sleep around behind your back?”

I was thrown by her shock.

“You really think, I'd bring a man into our apartment.”

She took a step toward me; I fell back toward the bed.

“Bring him up to our bedroom.” Her emphasis on 'our', her breasts heaved. I looked down at them for just an instant. I noticed her nipples harden the split second before she grabbed my chin and forced my attention back to her eyes.

“Look at me, not my tits.”

I wanted to say something smart, like her tits were a part of her, but my sarcasm fled her stern look, her flared nostrils.

“You think that little of me, that I'd fuck another man in our bed behind your back?”

I wanted to say I was only teasing. A thousand pleas for forgiveness flooded through my brain, but none would emerge from my mouth.

“Go on. Say something.”

My attempt at humor had magnificently backfired and the look on Daphne's face said I'd be spending a few days sleeping on the couch. I was about to get on my knees and beg when my wife started smiling.

“Man, Rich, you should see the look on your face, pale as – oh now it's turning red.”

“You knew. I didn't really think you'd bring him up?”

“Of course.” My wife started shaking her head. “You are so easy to tease.” She started unbuttoning my pajama shirt. “So, tell me why you're home so early, and why you didn't call.”

“Tonight's – last night's – debate got cancelled. The story moved on so we got sent home. I didn't call cause I wanted to surprise you.”

“Oh, you did. Nearly had a heart attack when I turned on the light and saw you lying there.” My wife had turned us around and was now sitting on the bed as I stood between her open legs.

“So how was your night? Have fun with Brad and the gang?”

Daphne started telling me about her night as I knelt between her knees and pulled her panties down. Her musky arousal invaded my nose, sparking a flow of desire within me. She told me how she danced with Brad and gossiped about some of the doctors at work. Most of what she said went over my head as I lapped at my wife's fountain of pleasure, her moist lips tasted tangy and salty. I concentrated my tongue on her clit while I ran my fingers around her labia. She stopped talking and breathed out a deep sigh when I plunged one in, curled it up and stroked along the upper walls of her pussy.

“Oh God. That feels good.”

I continued licking and stroking, bringing her to the peak of climax, before backing off, denying her release.

“Fuck. I am so horny tonight.”

I paused my ministrations. “Brad make you horny?” I dove back in.

“Oh fu— Maybe. Sometimes – not tonight.”

I vigorously sucked on Daphne's now engorged clitoris – cutting off any more words that might come from her mouth. I drove her toward the cliff of her orgasm and then over it.

Her cries of passion were loud and I hoped the neighbors in the next apartment were away. I slowed my tongue as he climax subsided, until I was just lightly kissing her fuzzy petals and she started giggling. “That tickles.”

“I'll tickle you.” I got off my knees and stripped off my pajama bottoms, springing my hardened cock from it's awkward confines.

“I think at least part of you doesn't mind all this talk of flirting and infidelity.”

I rubbed my shaft through Daphne's lips until it was well lubricated then plunged it home. The warm embrace of my wife's womb drew a sigh.

“Daph, seeing you naked could get a blind man hard.”

“But—” I kissed her hard and began slowly – deeply – fucking my wife before she could say anything about how what I said didn't make any sense. She sighed into my mouth, our tongues dancing, our breaths melding to one.

I rose above her and increased the speed of my thrusts – watching her tits bounce in rhythm to my strokes.

“You have fun dancing?”

“Yeah.”

In Daphne's face, I could see the glow of another orgasm approaching.

“Brad gets you horny?”

The fantasy of the other man, I don't know if it really turned my wife on, but I did know it stirred something in me – something dark and frightening. I wanted to believe I could control it, separate reality from – whatever this was.

“Sometimes.”

The word sent a jolt through my cock. Daphne's eyes widened; she'd felt it.

“But not tonight?” I had trouble getting the words out between thrusts.

“No – Yes, I mean No, not tonight.”

“What. Got. You. Horny.” My cock pounded out each word on my wife's receptive pussy.

“Shut up and fuck me.”

I picked up the pace, with a force I rarely achieved. But I didn't shut up.

“Who then? Who got you horny?”

I didn't know how long I could keep this up. I felt my balls begin to tighten as that unmistakeable tension started building in my erection. I drove on, vowing to myself, not to come until she answered me.

“Really, Rich.” Her voice was rough, her breathes shallow.

“Yes, Daphne.”

“Oh, Fuck. Fuck I feel it. Gonna – cum.”

“You have to tell me. Now!”

I don't know why it was so important she say his name. A sick perversion – a mental hang-up – a deviance that would drive me insane.

The moment she took her breath, right before she spoke, I knew what she was going to say, and as the word escaped her lips I erupted inside her, my semen splashing deep, much more than usual.

Daphne came soon after and I kept pumping my hips through both our climaxes – emptying myself completely.

“Steve Speare?” That was the name that set me off. The man I hadn't thought about since we left Dallas; my wife obviously had.

We cuddled together, my wife and I, our sweaty bodies pressed together. It was messy, but comfortable, a perfect time to talk about our sexual fantasies, with that moment of mind-numbing passion over, but our bodies still flooded with endorphins, leaving us in a state of sated bliss.

“Yeah.”

“Why were you thinking about him?”

“Actually, it was Brad who brought him up. We were talking about you—”

“Me?”

“I do talk about you, sometimes.”

“With your boyfriend?” Daphne slapped me on the ass; I chuckled.

“You're so funny. Yes, with my boyfriend. We were talking local news and who our favorite anchors are. Brad, of course, loves that hot blond on Fox. I was about to say Lisa Simmons.” She's the morning anchor at my station, very competent, smart, and pretty, as all on-air talent have to be, but not overly sexy.

“But you didn't.”

“No. I didn't. I got to thinking about Steve and how hot he was – is.”

“Yeah, I remember.” The sarcasm bled from my words.

“What can I say.” I could tell my wife sensed my discomfort, and seemed to enjoy it. “Thinking about running my fingers through his soft blond hair, down his chiseled jaw, or his tight, six-pack abs.” She paused and stared into the middle distance as if she was imagining the scenario she had just described.

“You know he has six-pack abs?”

“It's my fantasy. He has six-pack abs. Where was I?”

“Running your fingers over Speare's abs.” I tried to sound aloof, nonplused, but I think my words might have held a mean edge. I wasn't mad, just trying to come to grips with our odd pillow talk – what it was, what it meant, and where it might be leading.

“Yes, down his abs to his—Hey feels like someone's ready for round two.” My cock, having a mind of it's own, was slowly engorging between our bodies. “Talking about other guys turns you on? Is there something you need to tell me, Rich?”

I knew she was joking, but I needed to explain my arousal. “Talking about other guy's doesn't turn me on, talking about you turns me on.”

“Me and other guys?”

“Ok, yes, the thought of you and other guys – for some reason – arouses me.”

“Then, I guess it's safe to tell you I want to put Steve on my Freebie list.”

My cock twitched and maybe grew a little more.

“But you've already got three guys on that list.”

It was a fantasy list. Celebrities we'd never really get to fuck, but who we'd be allowed to – if the stars aligned – without repercussions.

“Can't I have four?” Daphne turned around to face me, her lips pouting. Fantasy or no, I was standing my ground.

“Rules are rules. Three guys on the fantasy list. Guess that leaves Steve off.”

“I call for the substitution rule.” Daphne had been ready for my response and she had obviously given it a bit of thought.

“Now you're just making shit up.”

“No. We get one substitution and I'm using mine. I'm dropping the President and subbing in Steve.”

Throughout all this silliness, I remained rigid. Here was my wife, talking about the rules by which she could cheat on me, yet she'd never looked more desirable. Her long red hair was a tangled mess, her eyes smudged with makeup, but the fire that burned within them drew me in and consumed me. I wanted her so badly at that moment, it frightened me, as if I would cease to exist if she denied me.

“Ok. You wanna sub? You can sub. But first we have to fuck on it. It's not official 'til we fuck.”

“You're on, Mr. Hawk. Let's fuck.”

“The President is off your list. Steve Speare is on it.” I plunged my regained erection into my wife and once more this evening, rode her to another orgasm. Although I wasn't sure she came or not, Daphne fell asleep with a smile on her face. And although the President was officially off the freebie list now, I'm pretty sure, if the opportunity actually did come up and she did sleep with him, I wouldn't get too upset.

Chapter 3

The elections came and went; shortly thereafter I was offered a new position at the station, one with better pay and more responsibility, but one which cut heavily into the hours I had to spend with Daphne.

Every news show at the station had a producer to pick stories, set their order in the rundown and decide what pictures and graphics to use to make the stories interesting and keep the viewers from switching the channel. One of the producer's greatest allies in this process is the assignment editor, who collects story ideas from reporters, telephone tip lines, magazines and newspapers, faxes, press releases, police scanners and gossip they hear at the coffee shop. If something catches their eye, they assign a reporter to cover it.

A producer is responsible for one show, but an assignment editor is tasked with coming up with stories for the entire station. I was offered the position as Assistant Assignment Editor after two years at the station. My salary would almost double and I wouldn't have to come in at three in the morning. Instead, I would come in at one in the afternoon and work until the end of the ten o'clock show.

I talked it over with Daphne and we agreed the added income would really help us save for when we started a family. We knew that in a few years we'd want to have kids and a nice nest egg would take a lot of financial pressure off us.

"It'll mean less time together." A brief look of disappointment passed across my wife's face as I went down the cons of the promotion. "You'll be asleep when I get home and I really won't feel like getting up when you're heading off to the hospital."

“I could quit.” It was an offer given in good faith, but one I couldn't accept.

“You'd be bored in a month.”

“We'd survive.”

“But you'd hate every minute of it, and you'd end up blaming me. You're not meant to be a stay-at-home wife, Daph. Don't worry. We'll get through this, and we'll have the weekends.”

I took the job and we settled into a new normal, becoming more like roommates with benefits than a couple. During the week we never really saw each other fully awake. Just as I predicted, Daphne was fast asleep when I got home at eleven and when she headed off to work each morning at six I was just able to muster enough energy for a quick kiss and a mumbled, 'love ya' before I fell back to sleep.

Despite this, or maybe because of it, our sex life greatly improved, at least initially. Each weekend we'd make up for our lack of intimacy during the week with passionate, aggressive, sex. We were like two lovers separated and then reunited each Saturday. Sometimes we'd start Friday night. Daphne would wait up and meet me at the door sometimes wearing lingerie, sometimes nothing at all. Each time was a delight. We'd have sex and go to sleep exhausted. We'd get up around nine or ten Saturday morning and have breakfast. Sometimes we'd fuck before, sometimes after.

Sunday we'd go to church, or see a movie, or picnic in the park, our options only limited by the fact we lived in a city surrounded by corn and soybean fields. At night we'd have a late meal, maybe a bottle of wine, and just cuddle, enjoying each other's presence. Sometimes we'd make love, but not always.

We did always fall asleep in each other's arms.

Maybe once or twice a month, I'd coax Daphne into a Monday morning blow-job or she'd serve me breakfast in bed, consisting of me kneeling on the floor with my head up her work skirt licking her to one and sometimes two orgasms. She'd leave for work without her panties, and I was hard all day at the station, thinking of my wife going commando and her co-workers not knowing it.

I'd imagine her sneaking off to the lady's room for a quickie with herself and sometimes in these dirty daydreams of mine, she'd get caught and have to blow some co-worker to keep him from ratting her out. On those occasions I have to take a trip to the bathroom to stroke myself back to sanity. I didn't know where all these thoughts of my wife's indiscretions were coming from – I'm sure it had something to do with how we teased each other – but I tried not to think about what they said about my relationship.

It was an odd routine, but it worked for us. Every two weeks the paychecks were deposited and our savings account grew and the prospects of our future become more secure.

The honeymoon arrangement lasted about four months. Twice or three-times a week sex became one or two until finally, about half a year into my promotion, we were only making love maybe once a month.

It wasn't that we'd fallen out of love, I still cared deeply for Daphne and I'm sure she felt the same. I guess it's that sex had become so routine, and we never had the time to spice things up. One thing that never failed to get me hard was thinking about my wife with another man, and it drove me nuts. I didn't understand it. When I imagined Daphne fucking someone

else I got insanely jealous, mad, and diamond hard. It made no sense to me. I was sure I didn't actually want her to do it, but I enjoyed teasing her about it.; I loved how wet and horny she got, on the rare occasions I brought up Brad or her freebie list. And we always ended up having amazing sex when I did.

Even though my wife and I didn't spend a lot of time together, neither of us was lonely. We both had made friends with our co-workers and occasionally socialized with them. Daphne regularly enjoyed an after-work drink on Thursday with the gang from accounting, and yes Brad sometimes joined them; those were the weekends we ended up having sex.

As for me, I'd go out with my friends on the evening shift: photogs, reporters, producers, hell, even an intern now and then. We'd grab a bite to eat at an all-night diner and maybe a drink after. One Tuesday night we ended up staying on the air past midnight, keeping viewers informed about a particularly nasty weather system that spawned a few large twisters that tore up some soybean fields to our west. Luckily the damage was minimal, no fatalities, and we got to sign off and head home after the National Weather Service lifted the warnings, leaving coverage of the clean-up to the morning crew.

Most everyone still at the station was tired and decided to go home, but I was able to convince the ten o'clock news producer to have a late dinner, really an early breakfast, with me at the Denny's near the station.

"You married, Tim?" I'd worked with the man for over six months and still didn't know much about him.

"Used to be. How 'bout you?" Tim turned his attention to cutting up his eggs and sopping the yolk with his toast.

"Yeah. Four years this September."

“Good luck with that.” His words were garbled as they shared the same space with his bread. Tim didn't seem to be a very careful eater or polite conversationalist and I thought that might be why his marriage ended.

“Why say that?”

“This business kills marriages. Hell, even if you keep it in the family and marry another news hound, you've only got like a twenty, twenty-five percent chance to make it work.”

“I think Daphne and I are doing fine.”

As if my wife's name possessed a kind of magic, Tim looked up from his plate of eggs and potatoes. He looked tired, his eye's bloodshot, a bit of dried yolk nestled in the crack where his upper and lower lips met. I know I had been working as many hours today and I hoped to God I didn't look as bad.

“This wife of yours, Daphne, right? She in the biz?”

“No. She's an accountant.”

“A civilian.” Tim tisked and shook his head. “I'd research a good lawyer. I doubt you'll be married this time next year.”

“You know nothing about my relationship.”

“She work second shift, like you?”

“No.” What was he getting at?

Tim shoveled another fork full of eggs into his mouth and spoke while he chewed. “I give you six months, then.”

I watched him eat and smiled. I knew I loved my wife and she loved me and I wasn't going to let this schlub poison my life.

“You're looking at me like I'm lying.”

“Just cause your marriage failed doesn't mean mine will.”

“Rich, I'm talking averages – numbers – they don't lie. Hell, you might beat the odds, who knows, but I've been in this business almost fifteen years

and every guy or gal I've seen who came in married ended up single again. Only time I've seen people stay together longer than a year or two is when they marry a co-worker, someone who understands, who isn't bothered by the odd schedules and long hours, and like I said, most those marriages also end, eventually."

"You have a pessimistic view of life, my friend."

"I'm a realist. That's why I love this job."

"Well, I'll tell you, Daphne and I are doing fine. We love each other and trust each other and—"

"How often you have sex?"

I didn't think it was any of his business, and I told him as much.

"You probably started off fucking as often as you could, but eventually that passion fades, and now, you can't be bothered. Tell me I'm wrong."

I wanted to, but I couldn't. He was kinda right.

"Sure, you love each other, but." Tim paused again, he stared off, as if trying to come up with what to say next. I didn't care. I waved for the waitress to send us our checks.

"You're mad at me. I'm just trying to warn ya. I like you, Rich. You do good work. You're organized and you know your shit. Last guy always had to look up the Governor's name. Kept forgetting it. Anyway, I like you and don't want to see you get blindsided."

I thanked him for the advice, but didn't really mean it, told him I'd see him in the afternoon, paid my bill and left.

I didn't want to let any of what Tim said affect me, but it did. My once rock solid belief that Daphne and I were soul mates had gained the tiniest of hair line cracks. I wondered if she was really happy with our mismatched schedules, living deep in farm country, away from her family and life-long

friends. I promised myself I'd ask her and I truly intended to do that when she got up, in less than four hours, but I overslept.

It was six when I finally did wake up and I had little time to catch my wife before she headed to the office. That's when I overheard a conversation that fed my doubts and those tiny cracks burst wide open.

"Yeah, Brad. I'll be there." Daphne was on her cellphone, keeping her voice low as not to wake me. I guess I could have seen that as considerate, but my new found paranoia would have none of that. Her low voice was a means of deception, she was having a talk she didn't want me to hear.

I knew I was being stupid, but damn if what Tim had said didn't stick. My doubts were feral beasts and if I didn't say something I knew they'd eat me alive.

"Morning, sweetheart."

Daphne jumped, her mind focused on her conversation. "Rich, sorry. Was I too loud?" My wife's eyes shifted around the room, missing mine for the longest time. Not a good start.

"No, no. I was just." Why was I up? Did I go ahead and tell her about what Tim and I discussed last night? Bring up my doubts about our relationship or delve into her feelings, her wants? With my mind situated somewhere between wakefulness and dream-state and Daphne on the way out the door, this wasn't the right time for that conversation. "I have to pee."

"Oh. Don't let me stop you." I think she realized how that sounded harsh and she called me over for a kiss. "You know I love you, right, sweetie?"

Why'd she have to say that now? Was her conscience bothering her? And why did Brad call so early? Only one way to find out.

"Who called?"

Daphne looked down at the cellphone in her hand, then flipped it shut.
“No one. Just a co-worker. We're having drinks tonight.”

“On a Wednesday?”

“Yeah. Why the third degree?”

I guess I could have turned the tables, asked why she was didn't really tell me who called, but I didn't – it wasn't the right time.

“Sorry.” I kissed her goodbye then shuffled off back to bed. I tossed and turned for a bit, a cyclone of doubts swirled through my head, keeping sleep at bay. After an hour of torment I got up and made breakfast.

At the station, my work suffered. I was tired and preoccupied. My condition did not slip by Tim. “You been thinking 'bout what I said last night haven't you?”

I wanted to punch him, but realized he was telling the truth, not mocking me.

“Tim, my wife and I are doing fine.” I must not have sounded too convincing because Tim rolled his eyes and went back to planning his show.

The day ticked by. I made a few calls following up leads for a couple of the reporters. I must have checked the clock every ten minutes.

During the five o'clock news show, when I should have been watching our competition and seeing what stories they had, my mind was wandering through the foggy and unfamiliar territory of true doubt.

True, I had thought about my wife cheating on me, dreamed about it, and even teased her with it. But it had all been make-believe, just stories to add spice to our sex life. I never really thought Daphne would cheat on me – go behind my back to fuck someone else. I may have got hard with the fantasy, my cock shriveled up when I thought of my wife's phone call this morning. That was real.

By the time the show ended, I looked down at my notes and found a blank piece of paper.

“Shit.”

“What's wrong,” Tim said from his desk.

“I missed what the other stations had.”

Tim laughed. “Don't worry. I watched them. They don't have anything we don't.”

“Thanks.”

“You should take a few hours off, Rich.”

“Is it that obvious?”

“Yeah. If I'd known how you'd react, I'd have kept my mouth shut.”

I was about to tell him about the phone call when the rest of the crew started to fill back in from the set and control room, and I didn't want to get everyone involved in my love life and how fucked up I was – and over what? A tossed off observation about media marriages and an early morning phone call. It was probably all in my imagination anyway, but the effects my doubts had on my work were all too real.

I had a problem, I knew that, and the only way to solve it was to talk to Daphne, tell her my thoughts and hope she didn't get too upset. I knew she'd be disappointed with me questioning her commitment, but we'd get through that. I had to know if she was still happy with our life, and I needed to know why she was meeting Brad after work.

A smart man would have waited until the proper time to start asking those questions, but at the moment, the smart man in me was getting his ass kicked by the insecure boy. Instead of waiting until after work, or even better yet, the weekend – when we'd have all the time and privacy we needed to deal with my problems – I decided to meet Daphne at happy hour. It was a dumb idea, one I regretted the moment I walked into the bar.

The Royal Mail was a cozy pub near the university. Outside it looked like another strip mall establishment, but slip inside and you're transported across the pond to a London tavern with flags hanging from the dark wooden rafters: St. George's Cross, the Welsh Red Dragon and Scottish Saltire among them. A few tellies were strategically placed, showing a never ending stream of live and recorded football matches; you could call them soccer games once without getting thrown out, but not twice. And the aroma of shepherd's pie and warm beer greeted every customer. It was a great place to meet friends, grab a pint and chat the night away.

Daphne and I had eaten here a couple of times in the few years we'd lived in Des Moines, and I knew it was where the accounting department held their Thursday night get-togethers, so I figured I had the right place.

I was wrong. A quick scan of the bar took in a couple of women – maybe in their forties – shooting pool in the back, a young family – mom, dad and two kids – eating dinner at one of the tables and three chaps at the bar watching a match. No Daphne, no chatty co-workers. No Brad.

It was after six, and I figured if this was where they were going to meet, they'd be here by now. I didn't know where else they could be so I did the right thing and decided to wait to talk with Daphne later, instead of calling her and asking where she was.

The more I thought about my marriage, the more I realized how stupid I was being. My wife had never given me any reason to doubt her, even when we played with the fantasy I always knew I was the one she loved and I was the one she was pleasing with our talk of Brad and his big cock.

I decided the best course of action was to have dinner and head back to the station to do my damn job. The waitress, a young student with dark brown skin, obviously working her way through college, escorted me to a

table near the back and took my order, a bowl of Irish stew and a pint of Guinness.

While I was waiting for my meal I went to the restroom and splashed a little water on my face. All of a sudden the lack of sleep and relentless anxiety over my marriage had caught up with me. The man who looked back from the mirror had pinkish eyes with dark shadows underneath them. I was fighting to stay awake and regretted ordering the beer. I was encouraged only by the fact my shift was over in another four hours or so.

The haze I walked through, back to my table was instantly lifted when I saw Daphne sitting at the bar and a surge of adrenaline coursed through me. It turned out I did have the right place, just the wrong time. The bartender put a glass of beer in front of her.

A tough choice confronted me: have the talk with my wife now and sort things out or sneak out of the bar, pretend I was never here and have the conversation later. Since sneaking out would entail a lie of omission on my part, and Daphne was alone, I decided now would be as good a time as any to talk, and even if we didn't get everything ironed out, at least we could get started. Plus, having dinner with my wife was just what I needed to lift my sagging spirits.

What I had forgot was my wife was meeting someone. That realization came crashing down on me as I was about to grab my beer and my stew and head over to sit next to my wife because in walked Brad, in his blue jeans and a dark pink polo shirt, his light blond hair cut short, walking with a purpose up to my wife. It's a good thing I wasn't holding either the pint glass or the bowl of stew, because I would have dropped them. I was shocked, although I shouldn't have been. I knew she was meeting Brad here. I watched as my wife stood up and greeted her co-worker with a hug and a kiss. The kiss was quick, but the hug didn't end right away. They

stood in a loose embrace, exchanging a few words, smiled and then, to my chagrin, kissed again.

This second kiss lingered. With the distance and the dim lighting I couldn't tell if any tongue was involved, but it might as well have.

My wife is cheating on me was my first thought. I felt sad and ashamed and humiliated. All this time I thought I was the only one for her, she was my soul-mate, the woman I wanted to have kids with, grow old with. I didn't understand what she saw in Brad. Yeah, they were both accountants, but other than that, from what little she'd talked about him, my wife and Brad had nothing in common. Unless she was lying about that as well.

The kiss continued and I felt like storming up to the bar and breaking them up, but I hesitated. I knew in that moment, if I walked over there, my marriage was over. I'd get mad and say something regrettable, maybe act childish and throw a punch.

I wasn't ready to end it. Deep down I held on to the insane glimmer of hope that all wasn't as it appeared to be, that there was a reasonable explanation why she was meeting Brad, alone – why she was kissing him. I didn't know what it could be, but I knew I wasn't going to find out right now with my emotions flaring: anger, jealousy, and—arousal? That last one threw me. I was getting an erection watching my wife make out with another man. It was so wrong, but I couldn't stop watching. I wanted – I needed – to see where this was going. I needed to know what happens next. At that moment, I saw Daphne as a woman, an individual, with her own feelings, strengths and weaknesses. She wasn't my wife, my lover or my partner. She was Daphne, a woman, a sexual being – beautiful in my eyes, desired by others.

She was playing a dangerous game. I wasn't going to remain her husband if she was cheating on me, no matter how much the thought

excited me. And she wouldn't want to remain my wife if I treated her like a child or a prized possession. I couldn't tell her what to do, she would have to make her own decisions.

Eventually the couple's lips parted and my wife and Brad sat down at the bar. They talked for a while. Occasionally Daphne would laugh at something Brad said. He put his arm on her shoulder once or twice; she picked a bit of lint off his shirt. During all this my stew grew cold. It was painful to watch their interaction, they were comfortable together, like Daphne and I used to be, before our schedules got fucked up.

“Something wrong?” My waitress had noticed the food I had been ignoring.

“No. No. It's good.” I took a spoon full of gravy, beef and carrots and shoved it into my mouth. “Yum.”

She shook her head and chuckled to herself as she wandered off to take care of other customers. Truth was, even at room temperature, the stew was still pretty good.

Daphne and Brad continued chatting and I continued watching and eating. Later tonight, my wife and I would have to talk, but right now I had to get back to work and help Tim get his show put together. I watched the bartender set another round of drinks down in front of them, so I figured my wife wasn't leaving anytime soon. I didn't want to create an awkward scene, getting caught spying, so instead of going out the front and possibly being seen, I slapped a twenty dollar bill down on the table to cover my check and slipped out a back exit.

I wasn't buzzed, but the beer had taken the edge off my emotions and I was able to get through the evening news without a nervous breakdown. The drive home was a little tougher. I knew we'd have to talk; I had to know what the fuck was going on. Was she having an affair? Was she

planning on leaving me? I loved my wife and for all I knew she loved me. Yes we'd grown a little distant, but I didn't think we'd fallen so far that she'd run into the arms of another man.

As I approached the apartment complex the image of my wife, home, in our bed, naked and legs splayed wide, Brad, his pink polo shirt still on but his jeans down around his ankles, pounding away at her pussy flashed before my eyes. It was abrupt and I slammed on the brakes for no reason. Luckily no one was behind me or they'd have driven right into the trunk of my car. The vision was brief, but frightening, not because I really thought my wife was at home fucking her friend, but because I found the idea oddly arousing.

It was just before eleven when I entered the apartment and tossed my keys onto the kitchen counter. The darkness and near silence surrounded me, no sounds of hard sweaty bodies slapping together, just the ticking of the hallway clock and the hum of the refrigerator.

I made my way down the hall to the door to our bedroom. It was open. I looked in, but didn't enter. I saw Daphne lying on her back in the bed, a few beams of cold white light from a street lamp shone through the blinds, leaving a striped pattern on the bed. My wife's head was in shadows but I could see her ample chest rising and falling under the covers.

Before I got home I had convinced myself the best thing to do was wake my wife and talk about what happened, but seeing her lying there, peacefully asleep, I found I lacked the desire to disturb her and get into a big row about our future. Maybe I was wrong and it could wait until the weekend.

Sleep wasn't going to come easy tonight so instead of tossing and turning and waking Daphne, I decided to sleep on the sofa.

“You gonna just stand there or come to bed?”

I jumped a bit. My wife hadn't been asleep.

“Sorry for waking you.”

“Wasn't asleep. You okay?”

“Just thought I'd sleep on the couch.”

“I smell bad or something?”

For all I knew she smelled of Guinness and Brad. “Something.”

“Rich, what is it?”

I didn't know what to say. My emotions were in turmoil, I'd decided to confront her, then put it off and now I didn't know what to do. While I stood there silently trying to answer that simple, yet complex question, Daphne sat up in the bed and turned on the lamp on her nightstand.

After my eyes readjusted to the light, I realized my wife was naked, at least from the waist up, I couldn't tell if she had anything on below because she was still half-covered by the bed linen.

She was a vision, her pale pink skin glistened in the warm lamp light, a tress of her long red hair hung down, covering one of her breasts; she was either cold, or aroused because the one nipple I could see was hard.

I wiped a bit of spit from the corner of my mouth with my hand. I could feel a tingle in my groin as blood rushed to my penis and I quickly moved to adjust my growing erection.

Daphne raised her right eyebrow.

“What?”

“You gonna just stare at me or tell me what's wrong?”

“What makes you think something's wrong?”

“You'd rather sleep on the couch than with your wife.”

“Oh. That.” I was stumbling for something to say. How does one start a conversation like this? It was always easy before, teasing each other

about 'the other man' when we – or at least I – knew it was all just in our imagination. Now was different.

Looking into Daphne's hazel eyes, I couldn't be mad, she was beautiful and I loved her. If I stared at her body I was distracted by lust, into her eyes by her knowing gaze, into the wall above her head by the image of her fucking Brad. I was a mess.

I opened my lips to speak, but nothing came out, so I closed them again.

“Let's start simple. Did the show go well?”

“Yeah, I guess. Went as well as expected.” Just words, meaning nothing, like weather talk.

“Anything interesting happen today?” Her words slapped me in the gut, driving the wind from me. Yes something interesting happened, I just didn't know how to bring it up. All the arguments I had devised to protect my pride dissipated like a wall of sand against the ocean wave. I stood there emotionally naked, aroused and afraid of what to say next. I wanted Daphne to go first, confess her transgression and explain herself. What I didn't want to do was admit I had spied on her. Despite the fact I was right and she did seem to be cheating on me, I was the one who doubted her first.

So I stood there silent, my mind racing. Daphne, for her part, held a stone cold expression on her face, no hint of what was passing through her mind.

Finally, out of frustration, I broke. “What do you want me to say?”

“What do you want to tell me.”

I laughed. “You asked first.”

“I'm just wondering if anything is wrong. Why you didn't come to bed like you usually do.”

“How do you know what I usually do. You're always asleep when I get home.”

Daphne smiled. “Not always.”

“So, you pretend to sleep. To see what I do when I think you're not aware?”

“Like you did tonight.”

“Wha—”

“Tonight. At the bar.”

“You saw me. I never noticed you looking my way.”

“So you admit it.” Daphne's breasts jiggled as she pointed an accusatory finger at me. “You were spying on me.”

“How—”

“I thought I saw you when I came in. You had your back to me, heading to the restroom probably, but I recognized your curly brown hair and that blue and white paisley shirt.”

I was confused now. What exactly had gone on between her and Brad? “If you knew I was there.”

“Why'd I kiss Brad?”

My mouth hung open and I mumbled a few odd syllables as my vocabulary temporarily escaped me.

“Why do you think?”

“Uh.”

“You really think I was cheating on you?”

I hung my head low, unable to look my wife in the eye. “Yes.” It was really more of a whisper, nothing I was proud to proclaim.

“I was teasing you, silly.”

I gave a sigh, as the weight of pain and humiliation was lifted.

“I was waiting for you to come over and say something. But you never did, so I kept on flirting. I figured you like watching.”

I still wasn't sure I believed everything she was saying. “Why were you meeting Brad? You told me this morning it was a girl's night out.”

“No. I said I was meeting a co-worker.”

“Still doesn't answer the why.”

“He's having some issues with his boss, and we're close, so I was there to help him out, listen to him and give him some advise.”

I was feeling kind of stupid, but still annoyed. “You always kiss him, when you meet up.”

“No.” Then Daphne chuckled. “But I might start. He's a good kisser.”

“Daph!”

My wife was staring into the middle distance, reminiscing the encounter.

“Maybe, I'll even let him feel me up.”

My cock twitched as my wife talked. I hadn't noticed I'd become turgid.

“Come here and let me take care of that.” Daphne reached out to me.

“I should be mad at you. For kissing another man.”

“You could have stopped me. One word. I'm the one who should be mad. At you, for spying on me.”

I had nothing to say.

“No come over here. I need some lovin'. I'm horny and it's been, like what? Three weeks since we've made love.”

“Twenty-five days.” I took off my shirt and threw it on the floor.

“So did you enjoy it?”

“What? The three weeks since we've had sex?”

“Funny. No, the show I put on?”

“Not really. I was more hurt.”

“Oh, poor dear. I'm sorry.”

I lowered my pants and kicked them off. I now stood at the side of the bed with my erection straining against my boxers.

“Our little discussion seems to have gotten you excited.”

“That and a beautiful naked woman in my bed.”

Daphne released my cock from its confinement and slowly began to stroke it. “You have a beautiful woman in your bed every night.”

“Oh. Oh, god that feels good. Not every night—”

My wife had taken me into her warm mouth. I brushed the hair away from her face so I could watch her. It was an erotic sight, until I had to close my eyes as waves of pleasure rolled over me. She licked all along the underside of my shaft and up around the edge of the crown.

“You like that?” My wife continued to jack me off, while she asked her silly question.

“Oh, yeah,”

“You ready for more?”

“Fuck yeah. You ready?”

“I've been ready all night. No matter what you *thought* I was doing, I haven't fucked anyone tonight.”

“You didn't, you know?” I made a rubbing motion near the base of my cock.

“No, I didn't play with myself, either. I was saving it for you,”

“I better not disappoint.”

“Fucking right.” I loved it when Daphne talked dirty.

I tossed the covers to the side and moved to settle between her thighs.

“Not necessary.” My wife grabbed my head and pulled me up for a kiss. “I love how you eat me, but I need something a little bigger inside me

right now.”

“Happy to serve.”

I adjusted myself and lined my erection up with Daphne's exceedingly wet lower lips. I slid in with hardly any resistance.

“You weren't kidding.”

“No, I wasn't fucking kidding. Please just fuck me.”

I began slowly so as not to come too quickly.

After a day of agony and doubt, it felt so good to feel my wife's hot pussy wrapped around my cock. We moved together, a well lubricated machine, our bodies colliding in time to a rhythm of our own making.

Daphne met me thrust for thrust until I could feel her muscles pulse and she let out a deep sigh. I came a moment later and my eruption triggered another, milder, orgasm for my wife.

“I'm gonna feel that in the morning.”

“Did I wear you out?”

“It's late. And I've got to be up in like, five hours.”

We laid together spooning, my wife's back pressed hard against my chest, my now deflated penis nestled comfortably between us.

“I'm sorry for spying on you today.”

“At least you admit it.”

“I kept waiting for you to admit you kissed Brad.”

“And I was waiting for you to tell me you watched me kissing Brad.”

We had both done wrong, only my transgression was worse. Daphne had only been teasing. I had truly doubted my wife.

“I let a stupid comment get under my skin. That, and the conversation I overheard between you and Brad this morn—”

“Shh.” Daphne rubbed her body against mine. The friction brought new life to my cock. “Brad's been going through some rough times at work

and I was just – oh, looks like someone's ready for a second round.”

“Is it okay if I ask for a rain check?”

Daphne reached between us and started stoking my growing erection.

“You are naughty.”

“Don't you like it?”

“I love it.”

After I was nice and hard, I eased into my wife from behind and slowly pushed in and out. We made love this way for a few minutes, a warm feeling of peace passed between us.

“So, you like watching me flirt?”

I reached around and started rubbing my wife's clit. “I didn't like it when I thought you were cheating.”

“Richard. I'd never cheat on you.”

“But, I do like it when we tease each other. And the fantasy of you and someone else does arouse me.”

“You wanna watch me again?”

My cock flinched at the thought. “Watch you fucking?”

Again, an involuntary spasm passed through my cock.

“Oh, no. Just flirt. But if—”

I put my finger, slick with Daphne's juices to her lips. I could watch her flirt but more than that, I wasn't sure. I didn't want that question raised. Not yet.

My attention was drawn from my inner turmoil to the sexy minx I had in bed with me when my wife started sucking on the finger I'd put to her mouth.

“You like the taste?”

“Maybe. It's not – revolting.”

Then the thought of Daphne making out with another woman entered my mind and my libido leveled up and I started thrusting with a renewed vigor.

“Rich, Oh god. You're gonna wear my pussy out.”

I kept at it, pounding as best and as hard as I could and Daphne kept pushing back to meet each and every thrust.

“I'm trying.”

I could feel my climax approach, a dam deep inside my groin straining to hold back the forces. It felt so good, the friction and my thoughts. My dirty, dirty thoughts. Then my wife reached between her legs and ran her fingertips across my balls and the dam burst. I flooded her womb for the second time that evening.

“Yeah, baby. Gimme that cum. Fill me up.”

“Fuck. Fuck. Fuck.” I did the best I could to comply. I counted at least six or seven good solid spurts, until I was lost in the pleasure of my wife.

After we came down, Daphne slipped out of bed to use the toilet.

“So, *do* you want to watch me?” I could just make out what my wife said over the sound of her peeing.

“Watch you piss?”

“Ha. Ha. No. Watch me flirt.”

“With Brad?”

“Maybe. Yeah.”

“Gotta chose.”

“Is it fair to him?”

“It's just a little kissing.”

“What if he starts falling in love.”

“Hold on.” Daphne washed her hands and returned to bed, this time wearing a tank top and a pair of lacy boy short. She snuggled into my arms.

“I won't let him.”

So we laid in bed and made plans for me to watch my wife flirting and making out with her friend, sometime in the future.

That night I dreamt I caught my wife sleeping with another man. I didn't recognize him, but I watched as he pressed her up against the wall and fucked her brains out. He was relentless, driving himself into my wife, his well-toned ass flexing with each thrust. Daphne stared at me throughout, her eyes filled with passion and lust, smiling at my discomfort, until she threw her head back and cried out in passion as she came on his steely cock.

I awoke the next morning drenched in sweat, with a raging hard-on in an empty bed.

Chapter 4

We never did get a chance to indulge our flirting fantasy with Brad. The urgency of the moment passed and work issues came up. Our sex life did rev up with the injection of erotic nitro, but even that eventually dissipated and we went back to making love once or twice a month.

The season passed; summer became fall followed by winter. Another year gone and I felt as if my life was swirling away from me. I loved my job, but I felt so alone. I had a wife I only really saw two or three days a week. Thank god for the two weeks of vacation we got.

About a year after the 'incident' at the Royal Mail, we took a trip back home to Texas. We planned to see our parents, check in with some friends and visit a few of our favorite haunts from college. Stepping off the plane at DFW airport and breathing the heavy city air felt like home. We rented a car and checked into the Sheraton in downtown Dallas about an hour after we landed.

“Wanna go out tonight?” My wife was unpacking her suitcase and looking forward to having a little fun. I'd like to have agreed, but I was exhausted. I looked at my watch. It was six thirty – not really late, but after that flight I just wanted to relax in the room, watch a little television and go to bed early.

I decided to offer a compromise. “How about we go down to the hotel restaurant and grab a bite to eat there?”

Daphne agreed and I told her to go down and grab us a table while I freshened up. After a quick pee and a splash of cold water on my face, I felt much better.

The hotel restaurant was a medium sized sports bar and grill, dimly lit by a few rays from the setting sun steaming through the windows and the cold glow of the many televisions hanging on every available empty space on the wall. Half the screens showed the Texas Rangers game, the rest a mix of sports news shows that could only be followed by reading the closed captioning.

The place was about half full, which seemed pretty good for a Thursday night, downtown, away from the club district. I scanned the restaurant and was disappointed to find my wife had picked a spot at the bar. There were several empty tables that would have been more comfortable, in my opinion. I was in the mood for a nice quiet meal, just the two of us, but Daphne seemed to be in a more 'social' mood.

She was chatting with the bartender, a tall fella, thin, with short curly hair and a rich dark skin tone. She was sitting near the far end of the bar, the seats on both sides of her were empty. I felt a mild queasy feeling develop in my gut. All my wife was doing was talking to a guy, a handsome guy no less, and my jealousy meter was going haywire. Surprisingly I wasn't mad, instead I was growing aroused. I wasn't sure what was going on, so I decided to stand away and watch.

I moved away from the door and sat down at a small table in a dark corner. I was sure my wife hadn't seen me, her back was to me the whole time and I didn't see any mirrors behind the bar. This wasn't going to be a repeat of the Royal Mail.

Eventually the guy behind the bar had to stop chatting and get back to making drinks for other patrons.

Daphne continued to sit alone, nursing the white wine she'd ordered and watching the man work. I could just imagine the dirty thoughts going through her head as she stared at the bartender's muscular ass.

After a few minutes, my wife tore her eyes away and looked around the room and then at her watch. She was tapping her feet against the stool legs and I knew she was getting antsy. She must have been wondering where I was.

This would have been the perfect time to show up, but I really enjoyed watching Daphne, seeing how she reacted when I wasn't around. She was a beautiful woman and I couldn't help but notice a few of the other men at the bar glancing her way. I knew someone would soon make a move on her and I wanted to see how she would deal with a stranger.

I took my phone out and sent my wife a text.

- Sorry. Got hung up. Be down in ten minutes. Luv ya.

I was playing with fire, I knew, but this seemed like a safe environment and I figured things couldn't get too out of hand.

I hit send and a moment later my wife's phone rang – a Coldplay song that was popular a few years ago was the ring tone she used for my texts – she never put her phone on vibrate. I could make out a furrow on her brow as she read the message. She tapped out a reply and my phone vibrated.

- Hurry. I'm hungry.

I'd have to be careful. I didn't want Daphne to get pissed at me.

- will do. order an appetizer and a beer for me.

I hit send again and watched Daphne's face relax. She closed her phone and put it back in her handbag.

My wife was waving down the bartender when I was noticed by the waitress.

“You want anything?”

I figured she'd kick me out if I didn't order something. “What local beers ya got?”

“We've got an IPA from Community and an amber from Four Corners on tap. Temptress and Blood and Honey in bottles.”

I was a little confused. I was expecting a Shiner or Lone Star. These other breweries must have opened since Daphne and I had left.

“I'll take an IPA.”

While I was ordering my beer, I missed a couple of guys who decided my wife was alone and needed some company. They looked harmless enough, standing there chatting, so I wasn't worried about her safety, even as little pin pricks of uneasy erupted in my gut.

They were our age, maybe a year or two younger. One of the guys was short, maybe five six, with short black hair and light brown skin, natural, not tanned. His buddy was paler with a head of brown, well-groomed hair with more hairspray in it than my wife used on her best, dress-up days. They stood and talked for a moment, but it wasn't long before they took the hint that she wasn't interested and moved on.

I don't know why, but I was a little disappointed. I think I would have liked to see her flirt a little with these guys. I didn't see them as a threat, someone Daphne would leave me for, just a couple of guys she could have fun, messing around with. Like Brad.

My phone buzzed. I thought I'd missed a text from Daphne while I was watching the two hipsters walk out of the bar, but then it buzzed again and I realized I had a call. Not a good time. It wasn't Daphne. She was taking a sip of her drink. My phone buzzed again. I noticed another man approach my wife. He was a little older, taller, pale skin, short black hair with a hint of silver around his ears. He was wearing a suit.

Buzz.

His tie was undone. Maybe he was having a drink before heading home from work. Or maybe he was from out of town, like us.

Buzz.

“Hello.” I tried to keep my voice low, although I probably didn't have to, the bar was loud enough with the hum of conversation and the baseball play-by-play going on in the background.

“Richard?” The voice was familiar, but I couldn't place it right away, especially while I was watching a handsome man hit on my wife. So many signals crossing in my brain.

“Yeah. Who's this?” My mind was still divided between the phone call and the seduction going on at the bar. The man had taken a seat next to Daphne and was chatting her up. She didn't seem to mind, but wasn't being overly flirty. She kept her hands to herself and smiled. I wasn't sure how I felt about that. Did I want to see more? Did I really want to see my wife cheating on me?

“Richard. It's Professor Hawkins.” The name rang a bell. A loud one. I knew him. I needed to focus, so I looked away from my wife and out into the Dallas twilight.

Immediately the fog lifted. “Doctor Hawkins. Great to hear from you.” Bill Hawkins was my advisor in college. We'd exchanged a few e-mails since graduation and were Facebook friends, but I hadn't touched base with him in over a year. “Sorry. I didn't recognize your voice. My mind was... elsewhere.”

“Hope you're not driving.”

“No. Just sitting at a bar. What's up?”

My advisor was never one for small talk, so he cut right to the point of his call. “I saw on your Facebook page you were going to be in Dallas this weekend and I figured you must be interviewing for the Metro-Plex News job. I thought I'd offer you my recommendation.”

What the hell? I'd been following the job boards and never saw any listings.

“Honestly, I didn't know they were hiring. I'm just in town for a vacation.”

“I thought you knew. MPN is looking for a five o'clock producer.”

“Yes!” I may have said that a little too loudly. Daphne and her companion both looked up. Luckily for me the Ranger's had just scored a run and more than a few people around the bar were cheering. They didn't look my way.

My emotions were running a gauntlet. Mild jealousy and pain on one side as I watched my wife get chatted up. Elation on the other as I learned the perfect job for me was opening up so I could get back to Texas. My head was spinning and I was having a hard time focusing. Blood that I needed in my brain at the moment was heading toward my cock and that wasn't good.

I noticed the gentlemen had moved his stool closer to my wife. She laughed at something he said and touched his forearm. He whispered into her ear. She laughed, slapped him on the chest with the back of her hand and shook her head. He ordered another drink, looked at my wife, then made it two. She nodded.

This was getting to be too much for me to handle. Watching the obvious seduction of my wife or focus on the phone call that would have a huge influence on my career; I had to pick one. My brain picked the job, my cock picked watching my wife, my heart, my real desire, was torn. What did I really want. Seeing my wife fooling around was arousing, painful but arousing, but it would only last so long. She wasn't really going to fuck him. Or was she?

Don't go there, I thought to myself.

The job, that was a step toward a more secure future.

The heart wanted both, carnal pleasure and my dream job in Dallas, it wistfully sided with my head. My big head. My brain, not my cock.

I left the bar to finish the conversation in the lobby. It might have been just as loud, but at least my wife and her new friend weren't there. It took about fifteen minutes to get all the details from Hawkins. He was a big wig in the journalism department at SMU and he knew the important people at all the television stations in the Dallas-Fort Worth market, including the News Director and Executive Producer at Metro-Plex. He gave me their numbers and said to mention his name. It wouldn't guarantee me the job, but it would open a few doors.

After I hung up with my mentor, I called the station and was lucky enough to catch the Executive Producer before she'd left the station for the day. She told me the job was still open and that she'd love to interview me. We scheduled it for the next day at two in the afternoon.

I was ecstatic, happier than I could remember. I knew I'd get the job. I had the skills, the experience and the right connections. I was confident the job was mine. All I had to do was print out a copy of my resume off my laptop and buy a nice suit, nothing fancy, just something better than the jeans and polo shirts I brought on the trip.

Visions of running the station filled my imagination as I headed back to the bar to give Daphne the news. I figured I'd have to shoo away her admirer, but I promised myself I'd be good natured about it, try not to embarrass my wife, since she really hadn't done anything wrong. It's not like she could help being so damn attractive.

I stopped in my tracks at the entrance to the restaurant. Empty seats remained, where Daphne and her friend were sitting just a half hour before.

A burning hot explosion erupted in the pit of my stomach. Common sense escaped me and all I could do was imagine my wife, off somewhere, making out with that guy, his face buried underneath her deep red hair, softly kissing her sensitive neck while his hands worked their way under her shirt to cup her breasts. Where had this vision come from? Did I think so little of my wife, that the first thought that entered my mind was of her, stepping out on me?

I absentmindedly moved to adjust my hardening cock.

Did I really have such a dark fantasy, that I wanted to see my wife cheat on me? I couldn't ignore the boner that seemed to confirm that suspicion, but the thought still sent a stabbing pain to my chest.

I looked around, in case they'd moved to one of the tables. They hadn't. My body started to subtly shake as more naughty thoughts about what my wife might be doing with this stranger invaded my mind. I needed to sit down, but not here. A few people had already started to look at me funny, so I headed back to the room before they got the wrong idea about me, although I wasn't sure what the right idea really was.

As I waited for the elevator, I slowly returned to my senses. Daphne was probably up in the room, having grown tired of waiting for me as she fended off all the guys trying to pick her up. It was the simplest explanation for her absence, even if it wasn't the first to pop into my head. It also turned out to be the correct one.

I felt like an absolute fool when I found Daphne in our hotel room, sitting on the bed, dialing her phone.

“What the hell happened to you?”

That question could be answered in so many ways, even true answers might not tell the whole story.

“Lining up a job interview.” I figured I'd keep it simple. Start big before revealing my anxieties. I just hoped she'd confess to getting hit on without any prodding from me.

“What?”

I explained about the call from Professor Hawkins and the interview I had scheduled for Friday and how confident I was that the job was mine to lose.

“That's great news.” Daphne jumped off the bed and into my arms.

“It's what we've been working for.”

“Coming back home.”

“Starting a family.”

My wife pulled back, just a tad, and looked at me skeptically. “You think we're ready?”

“Maybe. We don't have to start now. Let's find a home here. Settle in. See where we're at in a year or so.”

We could have gone back to the restaurant and had dinner, but we decided to stay in and order room service, complete with a bottle of sparkling wine, and even though Daphne's birth control meant she wasn't likely to get pregnant, we decided to practice starting that family.

Daphne scooped up a bit of frosting with her finger – the remainder of our dessert – and smeared a little on my right nipple before feeding the rest to me.

“I had a little fun at the bar this evening.” Daphne licked the smudge of icing from my chest.

“Did you?”

“Yeah. I had a couple of college kids hitting on me.”

“They give you a hard time? You should have called me.” I wasn't going to win any acting awards, but my reaction relayed just the right amount of interest and surprise.

“No. No, they were harmless.” My thoughts exactly. “Told them I was married and they moved on to other prey.”

Should I push? I mulled asking my wife about the older gentleman and divulge that I was watching her. Daphne took the decision out of my hands.

“They were cute, but not really my type. Too much frat boy attitude in them.”

“Not like me.”

“Nope. Definitely not like you.” She leaned up and kissed me. She tasted sweet. “After you texted though, another guy approached me.”

“One of the few perks of being so damn gorgeous.”

Daphne started tickling me and we wrestled a bit.

“Alan was nothing like those other guys.” My wife was now on top of me, straddling me, her moist lower lips leaving a trail of our fluids on my chest. “He was all man. Charming as hell. Knew when to be serious and when to joke.”

She had moved up my body. Her pussy was now hovering over my face. I could see her labia, red and swollen, a few creamy drops of my cum still visible. I licked the entire length of her opening. I tasted the salty tangy remains of our love-making.

“God that feels good, Rich.”

I mumbled a thank you.

“I could have sat and talked with him all night.”

My deflated penis started to stir. I moved my mouth away from my wife's pussy and asked the obvious question. “Why did you come back?”

“Because I could have stayed and talked with him all night.” Daphne's hazel eyes sparkled down at me, the tiny flecks of green and grey reflecting the warm lamp light. She was daring me to speak. Instead, I went back to eating her pussy.

“You know I'm not really talking about talking, right?”

“Uh-huh.” My affirmation may have been lost in her delicious flesh.

“Alan was so handsome. I would have loved to get lost in his inviting brown eyes, run my fingers through his salt and pepper hair. Uhh!”

Daphne arched her back and let out a deep sigh as a small orgasm rippled through her. This caused her mound to be pushed further into my face. I could hardly breath, but I was in paradise.

She eventually came down and collapsed on the bed beside me.

“So you're saying he's old.”

“Experienced.” Her answer, more a sigh than a word.

“And you wanted to... experience him.” I could feel my cock expand with this teasing exchange.

Daphne leaned over until her nose touched mine. “In every way.” My wife moved her hands down my body and grasped my erection. “You're aroused by all this talk about Alan?”

“We both are.” I reached over and thrust a couple of fingers into my wife's well-lubricated opening. She yelped.

She then threw her legs over me again and mounted me. She started moving up and down on my cock and I met her thrust for thrust.

Daphne threw her head back and became lost in her pleasure.

I believe in karma, doing the right thing, and since my wife had been honest with me, I decided to be honest with her.

“I'm glad you told me about Alan.”

“So. Am. I.” Daphne continued to grind herself against me, rubbing her clit against the base of my cock. I wondered if she was thinking about him or me. At the moment, it didn't matter.

I could feel her muscles begin to pulse, her nails dug into the skin on my chest and a low moan issued from her lips. “Fuck... Fuck... Fuck...” Her words were almost lost in the noise of the room's air conditioning unit.

“I saw you. Down stairs. At the bar.” I gave a hard thrust for each declaration.

“Wha—” Daphne's eyes opened wide. I kept up my assault, driving my cock deep with an urgency that felt primal. I wanted to drive all thought of Alan from her mind. I wanted her to know it was me, her husband, fucking her.

“I saw the dudes. Alan. The flirting.”

A few unintelligible words escaped her lips. I could feel my climax approaching.

“You were. A very naughty. Naughty girl.” I couldn't hold out much longer.

“And I. Loved it.” One final push, deep into her womb and I erupted. My cock pumping several blasts of semen as far up as I could. My orgasm sparked hers and I could feel her pussy convulsing, milking my cock for every last drop of cum.

Daphne fell on me. Our mouths meeting. We kissed – a fierce kiss.

“I love you. I love you.” Her words fought to escape her mouth between breaths.

I hugged her tight, grabbing her ass and pulled her to me as she remained impaled on my, now softening, erection.

“So, were you ever going to tell me you were in the bar?”

“You know how much I love watching you.”

“Yes. I do. Now answer the question.”

“Truthfully, I don't know.”

A darkness fell across Daphne's face. “What do you mean?”

“If you hadn't told me about the flirting firsts, if you had lied...”

My wife huffed and rolled off me, onto her back.

“... I don't know what I'd have done.”

“You think I'd hide that from you?”

I really didn't think she would. We were always honest with each other. We both loved how the teasing spiced up our sex life. I was about to say as much, but my hesitation betrayed me.

“You really think I'd keep that from you? Mess around with a guy behind your back.”

Before I could answer, Daphne sat up and grabbed my face. “Trust me, Richard. I will never screw around behind your back.”

She leaned over and kissed me. “I need to take a shower. I feel so. Dirty.”

I thought about joining her, but she closed the bathroom door – a not so subtle hint that she wasn't inviting me in. So I sat in bed and wondered where we stood. I figured she was just annoyed at my lack of trust. She obviously liked being watched but only if she knew about it. And I liked watching, although I think I liked it more when she wasn't aware. I wanted to see how my wife reacted when she wasn't performing for my pleasure, but for her own.

Chapter 5

My confidence paid off and I got the job in Dallas. Neither of us were surprised. I'm good at what I do, and while three years of experience is on the low end of what they were looking for, my knowledge and ties to the local community more than made up for that short coming.

The Metro-Plex Network payed for us to move, covering our costs in breaking our lease and putting down a deposit on a nice townhouse in Deep Ellum, one of the trendy neighborhoods near downtown.

It was around a month after my impromptu interview that I found myself walking into a new newsroom for my first day on the job. I wasn't expected to actually start producing until the following week, so my first day consisted of staff introductions and filling out paperwork for the Human Resources department.

I was at my desk, acclimating myself to the software I'd be using, when I heard an oddly familiar voice behind me.

“So, you're the new kid?”

I turned around and was greeted by the tall frame of Steve Speare towering over me. Granted I was sitting down at the time, but even after I stood up he was still a good inch or two taller than I was.

“Mr. Speare, it's great to meet you.” I offered my hand and we shook. His grip was firm and I returned it in kind. I felt an odd tingle develop in my stomach. I remembered the first night I'd seen this man, his friendly blue eyes sparking on my television set all those years ago, and I remembered my wife's reaction to him and that tingle moved further south. I hoped he didn't notice the slight stirring in my groin and took it the wrong way, but I doubted he was the kind of man to notice that kind of thing.

“Please, call me Steve, cause I'm going to call you Richard.”

“Make it Rich and you've got a deal.”

“Okay, Rich. Come on and lets get us some lunch. If you're going to be writing the words that come out of my mouth we need to get to know each other a little bit.”

It was really odd, sitting down and eating salad with a man I knew my wife would love to fuck. I wanted to dislike him, but I couldn't, he was too damn friendly and it wasn't his fault he was handsome.

“How was Des Moines?”

“Like someone took Garland and plopped it right in the middle of a cornfield.”

“I know the feeling. My first job was reporting for WSAV in Savannah. Great city, but I wouldn't want to spend more than a couple years living there.”

“Most excitement I had was covering the election a couple years back.”

“That was something.”

We talked a little politics. Steve was a moderate conservative, liked keeping his taxes low, but wasn't too thrilled with the whole “family values,” agenda.

“You married?” I hadn't seen a ring on his finger.

“Nah. Hard to find the right woman, willing to move around as much as I have. Had a couple close calls, but when I got a chance to move further up the food chain, so to speak, both decided to stay where they were.”

“Guess I'm lucky.”

“Takes a special woman.”

I don't know why, but I pulled up a picture of my wife on my phone.
“This is Daphne. She's the definition of special.”

I showed Steve her picture. “Holy fuck is she gorgeous, pardon my language.”

“I say the same thing to myself every morning I wake up next to her.”

“So would I.”

I was starting to get a little uncomfortable talking about Daphne. I wished she was here, but glad she wasn't. I hadn't forgotten about her freebie list, and who was on it.

“You seeing anyone?”

“I've gone out on a few dates with Elizabeth.” Steve said the name like I should recognize it. From the blank expression on my face he realized his mistake. “She works at the station. In accounting.”

“Small world. My wife's an accountant.” Daphne got rehired at her old job our first week back in town.

Steve and I discovered a few things we had in common, before lunch was over. We both preferred baseball to football, liked reading Kurt Vonnegut and Norman Mailer, and we both went into journalism because of Edward R. Murrow, although my dream started after seeing the George Clooney movie and wanting to be Fred Friendly.

That Friday I ran into Elizabeth from accounting and learned Steve and I had another thing in common. We both liked red-heads. And I knew I really needed to keep Daphne as far away from him as possible.

And so, after more than three years, Daphne and I finally had a compatible work schedule and life became much less stressful. Sure there was the normal stress of putting together a news cast five days a week, but

at least I could look forward to having a nice dinner with my wife after instead of coming home to find her in bed or heading off to her own job.

Daphne's day ended an hour earlier than mine, so she usually whipped up something quick for us to eat or grabbed take-out on the way home. We made friends with a few of the other families living around us and sometimes we'd have dinner with them, chat and gossip, share a few drinks. Sometimes we'd go out. There was a quaint little pizza place we loved to go to, a few blocks away, that specialized in infused whiskey drinks and thin crust pizza. It was a great place to hang out.

After dinner we'd snuggle up and watch television, or, if the weather was nice, we'd take a stroll around our quickly gentrifying neighborhood, admiring the murals and amazing graffiti on some of the buildings, or stop into a dive bar for a quick drink.

But, no matter what we did after work, we always made it back in time to watch the Ten O'Clock News with Steve Speare. And nine times out of ten we had sex afterward. Sometimes a fast fuck, sometimes a little hard, occasionally a slow, tender, coupling. No matter the mode, it was always good, the best sex and most frequent sex we'd had since our wedding. We were happy with our new lifestyle and I was knocked off balance when, one Saturday in June, a year after we moved back to Dallas, my wife popped the question over breakfast.

“You think I should go off the pill?”

“Wha—” I didn't have an answer. I was just getting used to having my wife back, did I really want to share her attention with children? My first reaction was to be snarky. “You talk to your mother recently?”

Daphne threw a biscuit at me, but I was ready for it and easily one-handed it.

“No,” she said with a smile. “I just think it's time we thought about having kids.”

“You think we're ready?” I thought it was a good question. Daphne's answer was puzzling.

“No one's ever really ready for kids.” She had a point. “We'll lose sleep, have to keep a closer track on our budget, and there's day care. Diapers.”

“You arguing for or against?”

“Neither. I just think if we're going to do this – have a family – we should just go ahead and take the plunge.

“Probably right. We should have the kids while we were still young and can keep up with them.”

“Look at you Rich. Being all pragmatic.”

“Am I wrong?”

“No.”

Daphne quit her birth control that day and we spend the rest of the weekend in bed, me trying my best to get my wife pregnant. Of course it wasn't going to happen right away, but it was fun trying.

We had sex every night that week and several times the following weekend, but without luck; Daphne got her period six days later. We took a two week break. No sex. No masturbation, at least for me. Daphne enjoyed her orgasms too much to quit, I was trying to refill my tanks.

It was hard – my cock and keeping to my abstinence pledge. Every time I watched my wife get out of the shower, drops of water sliding along the slope of her perfect breasts, her amber tresses plastered against her head, that beautiful tuft of fuzz between her legs, I wanted to touch myself, but if I so much as reached for my cock, Daphne would shake her head and tsk her displeasure. I'd pout and cross my arms, my erection bouncing

around painfully ahead of me. My wife would smile and run her fingers across her slick labia and I'd have to leave the bathroom before I blew a blood vessel.

At the end of the two weeks, I was so ready to fuck.

It was a Friday night, of course we had breaking news – a fatal car crash on the LBJ freeway during rush hour – and I had to stay late to help the six o'clock producer re-write her show. I didn't get home until after seven.

Walking was difficult as my cock was straining against my slacks. It knew the reprieve was close.

Daphne was sitting in the living room reading the newest Lee Child thriller.

"I need you." I hoped my voice sounded strong and forceful, not whiny.'

"Good to know. Let me finish this—" I pulled Daphne out of her chair.

"Don't you want to eat something first?"

"No." I pulled her toward the bedroom.

"You know, you've gone longer without sex. Your acting like I'd cut you off for a year."

"That was different." I began to take off my clothes.

"How so?" Even though she was grilling me about my sudden need, my wife also disrobed with the same haste.

Most of my blood had left my brain and rational thought wasn't easy at the moment.

"Before, back in Iowa, lapses in sexual activity were out of lack of opportunity, not active denial." That's what I thought I said. It really came

out like, “crazy. need. fuck. please.” I think I stretched that last word out a little too long and Daphne started worrying.

“Yes. Yes, you poor thing.”

I threw her down on the bed. She looked radiant, lying there naked, I'm sure of that, but I was in no state to admire her beauty. I moved to mount my wife, but before I could, she put her hand on my chest to stop my progress.

“You may be ready, my horny little beast, but I'm not.”

I knew what she meant, so I collected what little patience I had, and went down on her, lapping her dew like it was the fountain of youth and I was a withered old man lost in the desert.

“Oh. That's good. But slow down.”

I didn't slow down and Daphne resigned herself to the fact this wasn't going to be the best fuck she'd ever had. I pledged myself to make it up to her.

After she was well-lubricated with my saliva and her own juices, I mounted her. It felt warm and wonderful and I only lasted about thirty seconds before I popped and sent what felt like a gallon of semen into my wife's hopefully fertile womb. What I lacked in craft, I made up for in volume and I think that sent my wife off to a small climax of her own.

I collapsed onto my wife, spent.

“Sorry.”

“You should be.”

“I'll make it up to you. Later.”

“Damn straight. I should make you go down on me.”

The thought of eating her out again, after filling her with my seed, was oddly enticing. Daphne had sucked my cock several times in the past, after I'd been inside her. She didn't complain.

“But I won't. We don't know which of those lucky boys will be the one to knock me up.”

As it turned out, none were lucky and Daphne got her period again. We kept fucking freely several times a week, never knowing which time we'd hit the jackpot. I kept my hands to myself – my seed was for my wife's womb only. We weren't quite ready to see a doctor, but we didn't want to waste any ammo, either. That also meant no blow-jobs, but I put that thought away because it was just too damn depressing.

We had a brief glimpse of hope in late August when Daphne's period failed to arrive on schedule, but that hope was dashed seven days later. After that, we just stopped worrying about getting pregnant and went on with our lives. It would happen, when it happened.

Chapter 6

“You almost ready?” Daphne was out in the kitchen area, jingling the car keys.

“Gimme a break. Party doesn't start for another hour.” I was trying in vain to adjust my tie; I'd spent the last ten minutes fidgeting with it, but I couldn't seem to get it right. You could argue I was wasting time in an attempt to avoid the party altogether and you'd be right.

My employer loved throwing money around, keeping his staff happy and putting out a top notch news product, even if few people actually watched it. Good thing was, MPN had the local contract for the Dallas hockey and basketball franchises which meant the station was minting money.

One of the highlights each year, or so I've been told, was the company holiday party. Daphne and I were very social people and we loved going out, so I didn't have an excuse to skip the event. My life had been filled with dread since I got the invite. My first instinct was to hide it, rip it up and forget I'd received it. I don't know what I would have done if I'd been the first one to the mail box the day it arrived but it's a moot point because Daphne saw it first. She was so excited about going she ran out to buy a new dress for the occasion.

As hard has I worked over the past several months to put it off, my wife was finally going to meet Steve Speare. She brought his name up every time we talked about the holiday party and the three times we had sex between getting the invitation and the night of the party she made sure to tease me about him. The sex was great, but I really worried about what

would happen when they got together face to face. The fantasy of my wife being naughty thrilled me, but I was still unsure about real life.

“Time to man up, buddy,” I said to the reflection looking back at me from the mirror. “Tie's fine. No more stalling.”

I guessed I'd find out how I really felt when it happened. I ran a comb through my hair, grabbed my jacket and went out to join my wife.

“About time. And I thought women were suppose to take too much time getting ready to go out.”

It was true, she'd spent far less time than I did getting ready, but she looked a thousand times better.

Daphne's red hair was done-up, held in place by some unknown magic, to reveal her slender neck. Her makeup was subtle, foundation, a little eye shadow – a glittery brown that made the green in her hazel eyes pop – and a lip gloss that accentuated the natural hue of her lips. She had spent a fair amount of time to make it appear she'd done nothing at all. Daphne had a natural beauty, no doubt, but to look this stunning took work.

She wore a snug green dress that reached down just above her knees, the fabric hugging every curve. Her neckline plunged to a capital V, displaying just enough cleavage to tantalize without being vulgar. To complete the ensemble she wore a bright red sash around her waist with matching heels and a green and red wrap to keep out the mid-December Texas chill.

She looked like a sexy Christmas present I couldn't wait to open later that night. I'd seen an empty store bag from Daphne's favorite lingerie store on the floor on her side of the bed and I figured she bought something special to wear underneath her dress, another surprise I eagerly awaited.

The party was held in the grand ballroom of the Hilton Anatole just north of downtown Dallas. It a great venue, offering rooms for people who

didn't want to worry about how much they drank, and was right across the street from the MPN studios.

We arrived around six o'clock and checked into our room. Daphne freshened up her makeup. I tried my best to steal a kiss, but she kept her distance, telling me to save my ardor for later. The party was just getting underway when we finally made our way back downstairs.

The Metro-Plex Network employed a little over seventy people, most of whom I'd met, and since it was Saturday and the next news show wasn't until Sunday evening, just about everyone was there.

"Where's Steve?" Of course my wife would ask about the one person not at the party.

"He said he's running a little late." We were talking with Rebecca Sanders, the executive news producer and my boss. "Trouble finding a sitter."

"He has kids?" I didn't know that.

"No. For his dogs." Did I hear a sigh of relief from Daphne? Maybe.

"Is he still dating—"

"Engaged." I swear I heard my wife gasp, but Rebecca didn't seem to notice. I looked around and saw Elizabeth, Steve's girlfriend – no, his fiancée.

"We're going to mingle a bit," I really wanted to get over to the open bar. I wasn't looking forward to Steve's arrival and I wanted to get a little liquid courage.

"Nice to finally meet you Rebecca." My wife leaned in to give my boss a hug.

"Pleasure. We really love having your husband with us."

The compliment felt nice. I loved working at MPN, even if my wife was lusting after one of my co-workers.

I lead my wife to a table near the front of the room. Space had been set aside for a dance floor and there was a DJ spinning a nice mix of holiday songs and dance tunes.

“You need a drink?” I looked down at my wife, getting a nice peek down her dress. The view between her breast set my cock tingling.

“White wine, champagne if they have—you looking down my dress, mister?” I was busted. I just smiled at my wife, who winked in return.

“One champagne coming up.” I headed off to get our drinks.

I bumped into Elizabeth at the bar. She looked nice, her red-hair done up similar to Daphne's, she wore a black skirt with a bright green blouse. We chatted for a bit while we stood in line. It was an open bar and plenty of people were taking advantage. I congratulated her on the engagement. She said Steve had popped the question a couple of weeks ago and was surprised I even knew about it.

“Rebecca just told us, my wife and I.”

“Your wife's here?”

I pointed Daphne out. My wife was looking our way and she waved. Elizabeth and I waved back.

“She's very beautiful.”

“I know.”

“Well I can't wait any longer.” Elizabeth got out of line and headed toward the back of the room at a pace that could mean only one thing, she had to use the restroom.

I watched her go, my eyes lingering on her smooth round ass. I scolded myself for lusting after another man's woman. I turned my attention toward my wife. She was sitting down, watching a few people dancing. I was enjoying watching her, swaying her body to the music, lost in the rhythm, unaware of the erotic thoughts running through my mind.

I was shocked when I saw another man put his arms on her shoulders and bend down to kiss her neck.

“What'll ya have?”

“What?”

“To drink.”

I looked at the bartender and back toward my wife. It was Steve nuzzling my wife's sensitive neck. I expected her to immediately turn around and smack him, but she didn't. Instead she tilted her head, giving him better access to her shoulders and ear lobes.

“Sir, You're holding up the line.”

I was finding it hard to think. Steve had never even met my wife and he was getting quite intimate with her and she was letting him. “What the fuck.”

“If you don't want a drink, could you please step aside.”

“Two champagnes.” It was the first thing that popped into my head, even though I really wanted a double scotch.

I was just glad no one else seemed to notice that Steve was making out with my wife, and she was enjoying it. She must have thought it was me kissing her neck, although I doubt he wore the same cologne as I did. I guess in the passion of the moment, small clues are lost.

“Here you go.” I dropped a couple bucks in the tip glass and took our drinks.

I was halfway to our table when my wife eventually turned around and saw who was nibbling her flesh. She jumped back in surprise, but still didn't move to slap him. I quickened my pace, hoping to get there before my wife made a scene. My penis was starting to grow uncomfortably in my pants and I wasn't able to adjust myself with my hands full of drinks.

“I am so, so, sorry.” Steve took a few steps back from Daphne, who, for her part, seemed to be taking the assault rather well.

“You. You. You're Steve Speare.”

“Please forgive me.” Steve took my wife's stuttering to mean she was upset. I could tell by the look on her face she wasn't.

“You always accost women like that?” I said.

“Richard?”

“I see you've met my wife.”

“I'm so embarrassed. I thought she was Elizabeth.”

“You thought I was your fiancée?” My wife's face turned red, her freckles stood out, making her look five years younger.

“It was an honest mistake, both Liz and my wife have red hair, although Daph's is a bit darker.” I don't know why I was defending him. I guess I just liked him too much and it really could have been an honest mistake.

“And Liz told me she was wearing her green blouse. I'm just so sorry.”

“Not a problem.” My wife had quickly gotten over her shock. Maybe a little too quickly. “Now I've got a great story to tell the girls at work.”

“I so wish you wouldn't.”

I agreed with Steve as I handed my wife her champagne. She took a sip.

“I make no promises.” We all shared a laugh and Daphne invited Steve and Elizabeth to sit with us.

For the next few hours we really got to know each other better. Steve and I got to share our stories about how we got lured into the news biz. Daphne knew my story and was amused by how similar it was to Steve's. Elizabeth went on about how nervous she was telling Human Resources about the engagement. The company didn't necessarily frown on

employees marrying each other, but they wanted to make sure no managers were directly supervising their spouse. It made sense to me.

“Let's dance.” Daphne grabbed my hand and dragged me onto the dance floor.

“He's a really nice guy.”

“You're saying that cause he's hot.” I was joking. I'd come to know Steve pretty well, since I had to write the words he said on air. I did think he was a nice guy and I wasn't too upset about my wife's crush on him.

“No, I'm not.”

“You don't think he's hot?”

Daphne smiled. “Of course I do, but I also think he's pretty nice. There are plenty of good looking guys who are total assholes.”

“Where do I fit in?” Did I really need the ego stroking?

“You, my sweetheart, are the hottest, nicest guy I know.”

Yes. Yes I did.

Daphne leaned in to kiss me. Our lips met. She tasted like a cherry pop, with a hint of cinnamon, sweet with a dash of danger underneath.

“And that's why I love you.”

We danced for a few numbers. The DJ played a slow song and Daphne melded into my body. She felt so nice, her soft curves fitting me like a glove. Her head was tucked against my neck, I could feel her heart beat against my chest.

“I love you, Daph.”

“I love you, too, sweetheart. When are you going to show me where you work? Where the magic happens.”

I chuckled. What I did was hardly magic. “A little later.”

“Cool.” Daphne sighed and slipped her hands down my back to give my butt a squeeze. “There's something else I'd like a little later.”

“Anytime.”

“I know.”

When the song ended, the DJ segued into something a little more upbeat.

“I need a rest.” I broke away but Daphne kept dancing by herself, swaying her hips to the music. She was the one with magic. The way she moved her body was enchanting. I could watch her forever.

“Fine.” My wife looked around and saw Steve and Elizabeth dancing. “You mind?”

She was actually going to ask Steve to dance. I should have said no, let them be. I should have taken the opportunity to take her next door to the studio, show her where I work. If I had that night would have ended differently. But I was under her spell and I would deny her nothing.

“Not at all.”

Daphne gauged my answer. Her eye's darted down. She must have noticed my erection because when her eyes locked on to mine again she gave me a wicked grin.

“I love you.” My wife blew me a kiss and went to step between Steve and his fiancée.

I went back to our table, Elizabeth soon joined me. “She's quite forward.”

“Wouldn't have her any other way.” And it was the truth. Something about her confidence aroused me.

“You don't mind her dancing with other guys like that?”

The music had turned, a driving beat, primal. Steve was a good dancer but my wife gyrated circles around him, moving her hips to the beat. She ran her hands up and down her body and several times rubbed her ass against his groin. I didn't look but I was sure he had an erection. I did.

“Nope.” The word didn't have a lot of conviction behind it. I tore my eyes away from the dance and noticed Elizabeth was also transfixed by the passionate display. I wondered if she was as turned on as I was. “What about you?”

“Whuh?” Liz was startled by the question.

“You don't mind Steve dancing like that?”

“Steve and I.” Her eyes were glued to the couple on the dance floor.

“We have.” Elizabeth paused for a moment, trying to find the right word.

“An understanding.”

I had no idea what she meant.

“I need to use the little girl's room.” And my companion was off and I was alone.

I reached to take a drink but my glass was empty. I took a last look at my wife and Steve enjoying each other on the dance floor and headed over to the bar.

“Let's see. Champagne, right?”

I needed something stronger. “What's your oldest scotch?”

“Glenfiddich. Eighteen.”

“Perfect. Neat.”

I meant to grab my drink and head back to watch Steve and my wife do whatever they were doing on the dance floor, but I got wrangled into a discussion with my news director and another producer about whether or not the station should invest in a helicopter. Before I knew it, a half hour had flown by.

I glanced around and noticed the room had started to clear out with only about a dozen or so people left. The DJ was spinning straight holiday tunes and looked to be getting ready to pack it up. The dance floor was empty. Daphne and Steve were nowhere in sight.

“Where'd they go?”

Elizabeth was gathering up her purse and coat. “I think Steve took her over to the station. To give her a tour. Said something about showing her where the magic happens.”

“And you didn't go?”

She gave me a funny look. “I work there. I don't need to see – where the magic happens.”

Was she insinuating something? Was this a part of their understanding?

I could have been more direct, but I felt awkward asking Elizabeth if her fiancé had taken my wife somewhere to fuck. The thought stabbed me in the gut and sent a thrill through my cock.

“Night, Richard. See you Monday.”

“Night Liz.”

I found myself alone in the ballroom, save for a few hotel staff starting to clear up the mess we'd made.

The air had a slight chill, the dryness made it worse. The full moon peeked down at me between the leafless branches of the live oaks that lined the path from the hotel to the street, as I made my way to the MPN building. I stood at the light, waiting to cross and pulled my jacket tight to fight off the nipping wind. I could only imagine my wife and Steve, making this same walk, standing at the same spot waiting for the same light to change.

Daphne must have been freezing with so much skin showing, her little wrap wouldn't do much for that. In my mind, Steve, ever the gentleman,

gives her his jacket and puts his arm around her and she melts into his embrace.

For some reason I notice, in my re-imagining of the scene, my wife's stiff nipples, hard due to the cold or arousal, probably both.

The light changed and I had twenty seconds to cross the quiet street.

The station was mostly dark, the front office lights were out but through the thick glass window I could make out a single lamp at the receptionist's desk illuminating our security guard. Tonight it's James, a retired Dallas cop working to supplement his pension.

I scanned my key card and the door buzzed open. James looked up from whatever he was looking at.

“Well, shit if it ain't fucking Grand Central Station here this evening.” He looked at his watch. “Actually almost morning.”

“Just need to get a few things from my desk.” I didn't need to ask, but I did. “So, who else is here?”

“Steve. And he's escorting this fine looking lady. Showing her around, he said.”

“Well, you have a good night, James. I'll let myself out the back.” I left our security guard to his crossword puzzle and headed toward the newsroom.

During the week, there would be some activity, even this late at night. Maybe an anchor and reporter hanging around from the ten o'clock news discussing some issue or another. By this time the morning producers would be in, diligently looking for some fresh new item to lead their morning shows. And there'd be a photographer in the bullpen, listening to police scanners hoping for anything interesting to get him out on the streets. But not tonight.

We didn't have a weekend morning show yet, so Benny, one of our Master Control operators, was alone running a slate of hour long commercials for miracle cleaning products and handy-dandy kitchen appliances. Around seven o'clock Sunday morning he'll segue into kid's cartoons for a few hours until switching to the live feed from a morning church service.

The cleaning crew wouldn't be in until four and the Sunday evening news producer wasn't due in until nine in the morning.

I didn't know what I was expecting to find. Steve showing my wife his office, or maybe pointing out the desk where I sat, or demonstrating the terminals and scanners we used to gather the pictures and information that was the life blood of a news operation.

In the pit of my stomach I feared I'd find them sharing an embrace, kissing like old lovers, hands exploring each other's bodies. The thought chilled me, but at the same time, sparked a burning desire that scared me more.

To my utter relief and disappointment, the newsroom was empty.

Then I remembered what Elizabeth said, about how Steve, or maybe Daphne, mentioned wanting to see where the magic happened, so I headed off to the Studio Control Room. That's where I sat during my show, making sure each segment hit on time, communicating with live remote reports and whispering in the anchors' ears when they needed to speed up or stretch.

I was hoping I'd find them there, but they weren't. I was still alone, this time staring at a wall of monitors of various sizes. Most of them were black, a few showed a pattern of color bars. During the show they'd display a live feed, some video clip or maybe a weather graphic.

I scanned some of the smaller monitors showing various satellite feeds and off-air broadcasts and the studio cameras. That's when I finally found

Steve and my wife. The black and white image was too small to see well, so I punched a few buttons on the control panel to rout the image to a larger color monitor.

Steve was sitting in his usual position, where he sat every night at five, six and ten. Daphne was in the chair next to him, like she was his co-anchor. They did make a great team, very photogenic.

I started to head out into the studio to join them when I stopped. My heart was thumping like a machine gun. Here was my wife, sitting alone with a handsome man and not just any handsome man, a man she could theoretically sleep with and I couldn't get mad at her. And I had the perfect opportunity to watch her without her knowing I was there, like in the bar, but only better. Would she be a good wife and keep her hands to herself? She did promise to not cheat on me. But there was the freebie list. Was that even a real thing? or just a device to spark our fantasies. I never really thought I'd be sleeping with any of the women on my list. My wife was in a very different position.

I could have stopped them there, before things went any further. I could have walked out into the studio and ended what ever he or she or they had planned. But I didn't. I wanted to see how far Daphne and Steve would take this, so instead of interrupting them, I watched.

The image was a little blurry so I stepped over to the camera controls to pull it into focus. I worked slowly to avoid actually moving the cameras. If I did, they'd know they were being watched. And I didn't want that. I wanted to know what my wife would do if she didn't know I was watching.

Then it hit me. If I could see what was happening, so could Benny. He had the ability to patch into any video source in the building, but why would he. The large digital clock on the wall read five after twelve. Benny had just started rolling the scheduled infomercial. Right now he was filling

out his logs, then he'd go back to reading a book, or playing a video game, or whatever else he did as the station operations hummed along. There was no reason for him to look and see what was transpiring in the studio, no one should be in the studio. So I put him out of my mind and turned to focus back to my wife and my co-worker.

I was used to seeing Steve on the monitor. I wanted to tell him to sit up straight, which I would have if we were in the middle of a broadcast instead of watching him flirt with my wife. At least I assumed they were flirting. I saw their lips move. They smiled at each other. Daphne reached up to touch Steve's face, brush the hair out of his eyes. That reminded me I needed to tell him to get it cut.

Why the hell was I falling into the role of producer instead of jealous husband. I didn't know. Maybe it was something about watching the scene unfold on a television screen that made me feel safe. Like it wasn't really happening, like it was just, a story. But that didn't make sense, because five times a week I put together a show, broadcast to millions of homes, showing people and events that were real. My news shows were real. My wife's flirting was real.

I wanted to know what they were saying. While neither of them had a microphone on, I knew a way around that.

Each on-air talent wears a wireless mic so they can walk around the studio if we need them to. Sometimes those mics fail so we have wired back-ups tucked under the desk and they are always on.

I slipped into the audio booth and patched into those hardwired mics.

"I swear it was an honest mistake."

"Really? You really thought I was Elizabeth?"

"Cross my heart, honest." Steve traced an X on his chest.

My wife just looked at him. His serious expression cracked and he started giggling.

“Okay. After a few seconds I did noticed you were in a dress not a skirt and blouse, and I glanced down at your cleavage and realized you had a much nicer rack than Liz.”

Daphne laughed and slapped him on the arm. “You say the nicest things.”

“I can't help it. I have a way with words. It's how I make my living.”

“If the people of Dallas knew half of what I know.”

“Hey. None of what we talked about is on the record.”

“I know. I'm just teasing.”

“So you really saw my first broadcast?”

“Oh yeah. And I've wanted to—” Daphne paused and looked around. Was she expecting me to walk in on them? It was a possibility. “I've wanted to... Okay, I'll just say it. I've wanted to fuck you ever since.”

Steve's eyes lit up. Daphne was never one to be subtle. The words drove a cold spike through my heart.

“And Richard know this?”

“He suspects.”

“And he let you dance with me? And sneak off with me?”

“Hey. I'm an adult. We don't control each other. We trust each other.”

“Maybe he shouldn't.”

“Shut up and come here.” Daphne grabbed Steve's tie and pulled him toward her. They came together with a crash, their lips met, hands ran through hair. They stood without parting. Daphne grabbed Steve's ass with both hands and pulled him into her.

I wasn't blind. I always knew Daphne found Steve attractive, it had been a part of our fantasies for years. But deep down I always figured it

was just that, a fantasy, make-believe. What was happening in the studio was not make-believe.

It was real. And it was the most erotic sight I'd witnessed, made more so because my wife was taking part. I should have been seething mad, but I wasn't. I was hurt and jealous, sure, but also incredibly aroused. I watched in stunned silence as the couple kissed, the sounds of clothes rustling, wet lips smacking and moans of pleasure filled the small booth I was in.

"You're a good kisser. Great with your tongue." I'm pretty sure what was coming next. I had been afraid Steve was going to seduce my wife away from me, but that wasn't what was happening. Daphne was in total control. "How about we find out how talented you really are."

My wife pushed Steve back down in his chair and then sat herself down on the desk in front of him. Her back was to the camera, so I couldn't see her face, but the expression that passed across Steve's face as he glanced down between my wife's legs was incredibly telling. He inched the hem of her dress up her thighs and his eyes widened.

"You wear those often?"

"First time. Special occasion. You like?"

"You are a dirty girl. Yes. I love it."

While they spoke, Daphne ran her fingers through Steve's hair. I guess she had enough talking because she pulled his face further into her crotch. My co-worker dove in with gusto. Daphne threw her head back. I could see her eyes were closed tight and not much else, but I could tell she was in heaven by the moans that issued from the small speaker next to me. It was a sound I heard often, but not as well, since it usually came filtered through Daphne's thighs as I was myself feasting on her juicy clam.

As I watched, with various conflicting emotions, I did have the wherewithal to press the red button on the video recorder. I wasn't sure

what I'd use it for: blackmail against Steve, evidence in a divorce case, or maybe the start of an amateur porn collection.

My wife was overcome with passion, Steve was eagerly going down on her, and I was battling for control of my emotions. At the moment arousal was winning out. My cock was rock hard and I dare not touch it. If I came and my desire to watch abated, then jealousy and anger might take over and I might do something regrettable.

What I really wanted to do at that moment was zoom in on my wife's face. I wanted to see the ecstasy play across her features. But if I messed with the camera too much, it might move and give away my presence, so I settled for a wide shot of my wife with her legs thrown over another man's shoulders as he went to town on her pussy. Over the moans and sighs of pleasure, I heard the distinct sound of moist lips being tongue-lashed. I found it odd, since I hadn't seen Steve remove her panties. Did my wife go without, this evening? She'd never done that before. She must have planned for this liaison all along, figuring she'd be able to mark a name off her freebie list.

As I watched this carnal pageant play out before my eyes, I wondered if I was using that fantasy list to excuse myself for not stopping them. We had used the idea of my wife misbehaving as a catalyst to rev up our sex life for years. Imagining Daphne finding pleasure in the arms of another man never ceased to turn us on. Was it so wrong to take that next step, allow her to actually experience another man's cock? My head spun with contradictions. I was repulsed at watching the future mother of my children abandon all propriety and wantonly indulge her sexual appetite, yet I couldn't look away. I was scared by how much I was enjoying it.

I don't know if it was the act of her stepping out that aroused me, or the fact I was watching her without her knowledge. It was surprising how

much I enjoyed watching Daphne acting out to satisfy her own desires with no thought to mine. I find confident women sexy and I was lucky to marry one.

Would I feel the same if she flaunted her infidelity in my face, taking another man while I was in the room, against my wishes. Fucking was one thing, humiliation was another.

Daphne was cheating, but with a free pass. I wondered if she'd tell me about it later, either in the cold light of day, when we could discuss the events logically, or maybe during foreplay one night, she'd bring it up to tease me and heighten our arousal. And here I was with my own secret, spying on my wife, hiding in the control room and watching instead of stopping her. I guess that made me complicit in my own betrayal.

A loud cry brought my attention back to the action. Daphne had arrived. She was arching her back, pushing her breasts toward the ceiling. She used one arm to support herself on the desk, her other hand was grasping at Steve's head, her fingers firmly entwined in his hair, pulling his face deeper into her treasure. He took it well, continuing to lap at her clit as she came down from a deeply satisfying climax.

This was the first time I'd watched my wife cum from this perspective. Usually I was much closer, so I could see the details, her parted lips, a gush of fluids, tensing muscles, eyes shut tight. My vantage point this evening allowed me, for the first time, to truly see Daphne experience an orgasm – not its affects on her body parts, but how the sensation affected her as a whole, sexual, being. She looked beautiful, her red hair had fallen loose and cascaded over her shoulders to splash across the news desk she was perched upon, her legs were stretched out, her feet pointing away, one of her shoes had fallen off and I could almost make out her toes curling up.

My cock was aching for release, but I held off. My own climax might ruin any pleasure I was receiving from watching my wife's infidelity. I needed to hold off, to see just how far she was going to take things. It wasn't too long before I learned the action was far from over.

“That was fucking awesome.” Daphne was not a prude, but she rarely cussed. Then again, I didn't think I'd ever witness another man eat her out like that, so relatively speaking the cursing wasn't all that surprising.

“Elizabeth's a lucky woman.”

“I know. You going to reciprocate?”

I really would have liked to see the look on my wife's face. “Maybe. I guess. Sure, you deserve it. Show me what you got.”

“Gladly.” Steve couldn't drop his drawers fast enough. He stood up and released his turgid cock. It was impressive, about eight or nine inches, a little longer than mine, but not as thick.

“Impressive.” Daphne echoed my thoughts.

“Bigger than Richard?”

Why'd he have to go and be a dick like that. Despite the fact he was about to fuck my wife – I was under no illusion that wasn't coming – I liked Steve. He was a normal, nice guy, not stuck up like some of the other news anchormen I'd run into in my career. Seems standing with your hard dick out about to take a co-worker's wife can bring out the beast in a man.

I considered putting a stop to the proceedings, barging into the studio and pulling my wife out of there. Part of me would have loved to leave Steve there, his dick wagging, hard and unsatisfied. Daphne'd already got off once, so she'd be good. It would serve him right. Of course he had Elizabeth to go home to, so he wouldn't suffer blue balls for too long.

The indignant part of me wanted to end it, but the deviant in me won out and the erotic dance continued.

“Well, is it?”

“You want me to call him in for a measurement? I can do that.”

Daphne paused for just a second. “Or do you want me to suck it. I'd really rather suck it.”

I chuckled. God how I love her and her filthy mouth. Even as I watched her kneel down to begin fondling and licking another man's cock, my love for her grew. She was gorgeous and sexy, a confident and complex woman. She was breaking our wedding vows, despite the technicality, but I loved her none the less. Daphne had taken a risk with me, left her job and moved to the middle of fuck-all Iowa without complaint. I felt I kinda owed her this.

My wife licked along the underside of Steve's shaft, up and around the rim of his crown then ran her tongue over the tip, taking a drop of pre-cum from his urethra, before devouring his rigid snake whole.

It was a goddamn masterpiece of fellatio. It was art. And when this was over I was going to demand a repeat performance with my cock replacing Steve's.

Daphne bobbed back and forth along my co-worker's cock. Several times he tried to grab her hair and take control of her speed, but she'd keep knocking his hand away. She was blowing him, he wasn't going to be fucking her mouth.

I was mesmerized by her skill, I knew it well. Occasionally, I'd glance up at Steve's face to see his eye lids flutter and his jaw drop open, but my attention was always drawn back to my wife as she worshiped his erection.

I heard a few grunts and then Steve said, “Oh shit. I'm close.”

Daphne took his member out of her mouth. “I'm not done with you yet.” My wife's hands continued to glide up and down his shaft, lubricated

by a mix of saliva and pre-cum. “You think you can get it up again if I let you cum in my mouth?”

My cock twitched at those words, said so matter-of-factly. It took all my willpower not to stroke myself. I don't know where Daphne got such a dirty mouth, but I was loving it.

The question was too much for Steve. He hesitated; so the decision was taken away from him.

“Not taking any chances.” Daphne got up off the floor and sat back on the desk, spreading her legs wide.

Again, my enjoyment of the scene was compromised by the awful camera angle, so I had to image the sight of my wife's pussy laid bare to my co-worker, her labia, moist and dripping, open like a blooming flower, a halo of curly red hair around it. Her little red bud would be engorged, aching for attention.

How I wanted to plunge my cock into her right now, but it wasn't for me. That thought stabbed through my heart and jealousy re-emerged. I wanted my wife now. She was mine, why'd Steve get to have her. I guess I really wasn't ready to watch my wife fuck another man. I took out my phone and dialed Daphne's number.

I could hear the phone ringing on my end as Steve stepped into my wife's outspread legs, his cock, hard and angry, taken in hand. He seemed to be teasing her, rubbing the bare tip across her swollen lips.

Then it hit me like lighting. His bare cock, no rubber, my wife's fertile womb laid open before him.

The phone was ringing but there was no sound in the studio. Did Daphne leave her phone somewhere else? I guessed I'd have to stop them in person.

“You have a condom?” My wife's words gripped me and held me in place.

“No. I wasn't planning on needing one.” Steve continued teasing her with his cock

“Not a Boy Scout then.”

“You want me to stop?”

“Yes,” I shouted standing inside a sound proof room.

Daphne said nothing. She just looked up at him. I saw a wicked smile blossom on Steve's face. I couldn't see what my wife's expression was, but I see her shake her head.

Steve stepped forward and Daphne's head fell back and a deep moan of pleasure filled the audio booth.

What the fuck was she thinking. We were trying to get pregnant. She wasn't on birth control. If she was going to cheat on me, the least – the very fucking least – she could do was make him wear a rubber.

The freebie list did NOT cover her getting pregnant by her lover.

Anger seethed through my body, but my erection remained, my cock hard and yearning for release. My brain, denied blood needed for rational thought, gave up control of my body to my baser instincts. I didn't move, I stood transfixed as my wife seemed to cuckold me by taking another man's cock without protection.

I wanted to stay mad. I wanted to let anger control me, but I couldn't. My love and desire for Daphne regained control. Chances were she wasn't at her most fertile time. I was sure if she had been she would have stopped Steve from entering her bareback. I didn't believe she really wanted Steve to get her pregnant, though in the back of my sick mind I thought maybe she was afraid I was shooting blanks and wanted to let another man have a

shot. I realized if that was the case she wouldn't have asked about the condom in the first place. Score one for logic.

The erotic coupling continued before me. Steve had bottomed out in my wife, his hips meeting hers with a loud slap. He took a moment to let her adjust to his size, and proceeded to piston his cock in and out of her well-lubricated vagina.

The wet sounds of lovemaking filled the room: moist friction, deep grunts, and high loud moans. Occasionally the set would creak; it wasn't built for this type of activity.

Steve grabbed my wife's ass and continued to drive into her, relentlessly. She left slick wet streaks as her body was pulled across the desk.

“Fuck. Fuck. FUCK!” Daphne came again with a loud series of mumbled words. She grabbed her lover and pulled her body tight with his. Holding him as she shivered, her head buried in his neck.

“God, you're good.”

“I can feel you pulsing around me, like your pussy is massaging my cock.”

“Oh! I felt you twitch. So deep.”

“I fill you better than him?”

Fucker.

“That important to you?”

Steve thought it over before saying, “No.”

“Good. I'd hate to hurt your ego.”

Daphne finally released her lover after her climax subsided. Steve pulled away from between my wife's thighs. His cock still hard and red, coated with my wife's lubrication. He hadn't come yet. “Turn around.”

Daphne complied. Now she was facing me, facing the camera, as she bent over and presented herself to Steve. Maybe he was going to ejaculate on her ass instead of inside her. I was relieved, yet also disappointed. I found it slightly hot, the thought of him cumming in my wife, and I felt a bit guilty for that.

I was looking into my wife's eyes, as she starred off into the darkness of the studio, when I saw them open wide. Steve wasn't going to finish on her back, he had taken her doggie style. The arousing cocktail of emotions flowed again, lust and desire tinged with jealousy.

Steve was a skilled love-maker, I could see in on Daphne's face. Her eyes rolled up and fluttered as she lost herself in the pleasure of her lover's cock moving deep inside her, touching places I never could. I was happy for her – getting to experience the feeling – but sad over not being the one to give it to her. I could see how much she was enjoying her fucking and I couldn't hate her for it. Yes, she was cheating, despite our agreement, but I loved her and I didn't want to deny her anything.

I, too, was lost in the pleasure of the moment. I didn't want it to ever end. I was enjoying it too much and when it was over, I'd have to deal with those feelings. How would Daphne feel? Was she expecting me to come in and stop her. Not likely since she couldn't know I was aware anything was going on. How would she feel when I told her I watched the whole time? Could she still respect a man who allowed another to impregnate his wife? So many questions. As long as the moment lasted, we, all three, were living a guiltless existence.

“Ohh!” Steve broke the moment. He pulled Daphne's hips to his, their flesh clashing, and held her as he came, his cock buried deep, erupting inside my wife's womb. Daphne also let out another sigh and might have felt another small orgasm, as Steve's warm seed spread within her.

The couple separated as they came down from their mutual climax. Daphne fell forward across the desk, her head laying on her crossed arms. Long red locks of hair fell across her face, hiding her post-coital glow. Steve collapsed back into his chair, panting. His now flaccid cock, lay across his thigh, slick with cum and my wife's nectar.

I sat down in a state of shock. I was still hard. I could wallow in loathing and self-pity, cry over my wife's infidelity, but I didn't.

A heightened wave of arousal overtook me. I loved Daphne and I desired her from the moment we first met. The emotion I was feeling now was different. It was a base, animalistic need, uncivilized and raw and a thousand times more powerful.

Another man, a rival, had inseminated my woman and I had to do something about it. College educated, city raised Richard was gone, for the moment, and caveman Rich emerged.

I'd never find out if my wife would have confessed her transgressions, because instead of walking out and heading back to the hotel alone, I stormed into the studio; civilized Rich was smart enough to grab the disk from the recorder as he went.

“Rich!” “Richard!!” Steve and Daphne called my name in surprise. They might have said more, but I wasn't really listening. I quickly marched over to the set and firmly took my wife's hand.

“Richard, let me explain.”

“Come. With me.”

I had the presence of mind to let Daphne grab her purse and wrap on the way out. We left Steve alone to clean up the mess my wife and he had made.

Emotions swirled though my brain sending hormones flooding my body. Time was of the essence. Millions of Steve's sperm were furiously

swimming their way deep inside my wife, hoping to find an egg to fertilize.

“Rich. Calm down.”

“Later. I'll calm down later.”

I took Daphne back to the audio booth. It was small, private, and soundproof. It would serve my needs.

I locked the door behind us.

“Richard, dear. I can explain.” Daphne's voice quivered. She thought I was angry. That I hated her. If she only knew how much I truly loved her at that moment, how much her actions had ignited a firestorm of lust and desire within me.

She was trying to take control of the situation. In another state of mind, I might have let her, but for now the caveman was still in control.

“Explain later. We fuck, now.”

Daphne was shocked. She must have figured sex was the last thing I wanted now. She was so wrong. It was the only thing.

“You sure.”

“Yes.”

I lifted Daphne's dress off. She stood before me in a matching sheer green bra and panties – crotchless panties.

That little slut. I smiled.

“You were expecting to be naughty tonight.”

“Let me explain.”

“Sure. Later. Turn around, now.”

My wife slowly turned around as I dropped my pants and took out my cock. She bent over, gripping the edge of the audio board for support. Her pussy looked so inviting, peeking out from between her legs. Her labia was red and open. A trickle of clear and pearly white fluids pooled the within the folds and started running down her thigh.

The evidence of her cheating threw gasoline on the fire of my lust. I lined up my turgid member and drove it home. Daphne's well fucked pussy felt slick and warm. I started plunging into her with a ferocity that surprised me. Moans of pleasure escaped her lips, but that didn't concern me at the moment.

I was on a mission. My hard cock pumping in and out of my wife's womb, trying to dislodge my rival's seed and supplant it with my own. I could see small globs of Steve's semen come out with each withdrawal of my erection. It was a stupid thought, but one borne of primal need.

Each thrust brought me closer to climax, like a cinched fire hose, pressure building on one side until it finally bursts. I drove my cock as deep inside my wife as I could, cursing those two inches of length Steve had over me.

“Fuck.” I erupted, with a force I'd never felt before. It was probably a normal orgasm, with an average amount of semen emitted, but in my emotional state, I was that fire hose, filling my wife with my seed, driving out the invaders.

I had reclaimed my wife and it felt so fucking good.

Epilogue

We made it back to the hotel room a little after one o'clock Sunday morning. It seemed like an eternity to me. We left the back way to avoid any funny looks from James, the security guard.

In the room, I was calm. My angst had subsided. Now, was the time for questions.

“Are you planning on leaving me?”

It hurt me to ask the question, fearing the answer would be yes. Granted, my wife should have been the one asking it.

Daphne didn't answer right away. She had to rinse the soap from her face first. “You couldn't wait until after my shower?”

“Maybe. But it's been eating away at me. Why did you cheat on me?”

“I didn't cheat on you Rich.” Daphne had her back arched with her head under the cascading water, her breast thrust outward. She looked so enticing. I almost stripped and joined her in the shower. She turned the water off before I gave into temptation.

“You just fucked my co-worker.” I handed my wife a towel. “You promised you'd never cheat on me.”

“I promised never to sleep with someone behind your back.” Daphne took the towel and started vigorously drying herself off. I found it difficult to follow the conversation while watching her rub under her boobs and between her legs, making sure she got all the excess water.

“But you did. Tonight.”

“Didn't you watch us?”

“Yeah.” I saw the trap, but I fell into it anyway.

“Then it wasn't behind your back.”

“But you couldn't know I was watching.”

Daphne wrapped the towel around her hair and stepped out of the shower stall.

“Oh, I knew, mister. The red light on the camera gave you away.”

“Fuck.” The studio cameras have small lights on them that pop on when their signal is routed to a live monitor. It lets the on-air talent know which way to look. “You knew someone was watching.” I began pacing around the bathroom. “How'd you know it was me?”

“We asked James to text us when you came over.”

“You assumed an awful lot.”

“Figured Elizabeth would tell you. If somehow you passed up the chance to catch me with Steve, we'd just tour the studio and go back to the hotel.”

“You wouldn't have fucked him?” My voice dripped with doubt. “You would have been a good girl?”

“Rich.” Daphne stepped toward me, backing me up against the sink. Her naked body, fresh from the shower, smelled of vanilla. The green in her eyes burned with a sultry glaze. “This was all about you. I know you like watching, but only if you think I don't know.” She reached down into my pajama pants to stroke my rapidly swelling penis. “I know you love the thought of your wife being naughty. You wanted to catch me behaving badly, so I let you.”

“You. Let. Me?” It was hard to speak, my mind focused on the pleasure of my wife's manipulation.

Daphne leaned in to put her mouth to my ear. “Yes. I did.”

I really couldn't argue with her. The idea of her with another man had sparked some of our most intense fuck sessions over the years. I couldn't blame her for taking that next step.

“It was all for you.” Her breathe over my ear lobes sent goosebumps running down my spine. I could feel an orgasm approach. Daphne quickened her pace. My release was imminent. My wife pulled her hand away.

“Besides—”

“AAAAAAH” My balls ached. I hadn't cum.

“You can't be mad, Steve's on my freebie list.” Daphne left the room.

“You planned this. Years ago. When you put him on the list.”

My wife was sitting on the bed, flipping through T.V. channels with the remote.

“Don't be silly. Steve was handsome and sexy and, yeah, I wanted to fuck him. But I didn't know we'd ever be coming back to Dallas. It was just – luck.”

If I'd been smart and thought ahead, I would have told her to drop Steve's name from the list when we moved here. But I realized it wasn't really about the list. It was about watching my wife and the thrill I seemed to get from it, damn the complications.

“Well, I guess I'll have to quit my job. Steve fucking my wife, I'd never hear the end of it.”

Daphne stopped looking at the television. “Rich, honey, I would never, repeat, never put you in a humiliating situation. This is about fantasy and pleasure. Steve understands that. So does his fiancée. They have an—”

“Understanding. I know. She told me.”

“Well then. What's the problem?”

I had tried to avoid the most troubling question I had, but it couldn't wait any longer.

“You let him fuck you without a condom. He came inside you. What if.” I didn't want to say it. “What if, he got you pregnant?”

Daphne smiled.

Her lack of worry hurt, but aroused me all the same. It was so odd, this pleasure I got from such a deviant situation. Did I really want to be a cuckold? Did my wife really want to have Steve's baby? I tensed up. No. That couldn't be the case.

“Richard. I have some news for you.”

But it was.

“I'm pregnant.”

Rational thought fled. She really was going to have Steve's baby.

“Why are you so upset? We've been trying for months now.”

“I don't want to raise Steve's child.” What the fuck was I saying.

Daphne chuckled. “You really think? In less than an hour?” My wife's laughter faded. “And you really think I'd do that to you?”

“I'm so stupid.”

“Yes. Sometimes you are. But I love you anyway.”

“And I love you, too. Even after you fuck other guys.”

“I think it's partly *because* I'd fuck other guys.”

“You're probably right.” Relief flooded through me, washing away the doubt and guilt. “That's why we're perfect for each other.”

“Yup. Now come here. I want to get dirty again.”

Later on Sunday, Daphne told me she missed her period the month before and, after two positive home tests, she went to her doctor to confirm she was pregnant.

I wondered about the alcohol she drank at the party, but she assured me she only had a few sips of bubbly. She poured most of it into my glass

when I wasn't looking.

My loving wife figured this party was one last chance to act wild and crazy before kids came along and civilized us. I promised her this wasn't our last wild and crazy night. She kissed me on the forehead and told me she hoped not.

I didn't mention the video I had. I figured I could save that for another time.

On Monday I found a note on my computer monitor at work.

See me in my office. Steve

I guess we needed to hash things out.

“Close the door and have a seat.”

Steve was an anchor, so he didn't have to sit in the cubicle farm like the rest of us. His office was small, enough room for his desk, a comfortable couch and a small table with a few chairs around it. The screensaver on his computer was a shot of him and Elizabeth at the holiday party. Although it was a bit fuzzy, I could make out Daphne and I dancing in the background behind them.

“Rich. I hope you know, I didn't mean to.” How do you apologize to a man for fucking his wife.

“I know. My wife explained everything.”

“Daphne said you were into it. But the way you came charging into the studio. I thought you were going to kill us.”

Now it was my turn to laugh. I was the last guy to resort to physical violence. Unless it was to an inanimate object. “Don't worry. We're all good. Besides how can I be mad? I'm going to be a papa.”

“Well, congrats.”

I sat down on the couch and we talked about our plans – Daphne's and mine – to start a family. We weren't planning on having just one.

Steve said he felt he was getting too old for kids – seeing as he was pushing forty. Elizabeth wasn't eager to build a family either. They had other ways of enjoying themselves.

“And Elizabeth doesn't mind you fucking other women?”

“No. And I don't mind if she does either.”

“Fuck other men?”

“That, too.”

I smiled when it dawned on me what he meant. “Nice.”

“I hope you had fun cleaning up your mess in the studio.”

“Not as much fun as I had making it.”

It felt so odd joking about him fucking my wife, but it also felt so good. Like a secret we shared.

I was about to leave his office when Steve said, “One more thing. I hear Haley Martin is going to be in Dallas next month. I think I can get an interview for you.”

I turned. He was smiling at me, a knowing look in his eyes.

“She told you. Didn't she?”

“Yeah. It's only fair.”

“Damn straight.”

A lot of wild and crazy nights ahead, indeed.

Afterward

For anyone wondering about the title of this story, it's taken from an old tease local news stations would use to get people to tune in to their late broadcasts. "Local man saves kitten from a tree, pictures at ten" Or eleven, depending on what time your local news started. Of course, if pictures from this story ever aired, someone would be losing their job.

I do appreciate feedback and I can be reached at seangeist@outlook.com. I try to answer all my e-mail. You can also follow me on twitter @SeanGeist.

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Bk2: Going Down to Get Up

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Sherry Tells Stories

What Flirting Leads To

Zahara